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23 Sept | 6:00 PM

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21 Sept | 11:00 AM

21 Sept | 11:00 AM

हिंदी माध्यम

28 सितंबर | शाम 6:00 बजे

5 अक्टूबर | दोपहर 3:00 बजे

23 सितंबर | सुबह 8:00 बजे

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IN BRIEF

Dispel confusion,
NDA leaders urge
election panel

PATNA

The BJP felt the heat within the NDA alliance over the SIR exercise on Friday as Lok Janshakti Party (Ram Vilas) leader Chirag Paswan and RLM leader Upendra Kushwaha urged the Election Commission to dispel confusion in the minds of the people. » **Page 4**

HC questions DU
over shortage of
hostel facilities

NEW DELHI

The Delhi High Court on Friday criticised Delhi University over its response on the issue of adding additional hostel facilities for students as “absolutely vague” while hearing various petitions on the September 6 Satya Niketan multi-storey building collapse, which claimed the lives of seven persons. » **Page 2**

J&K CM moves
resolution on
Statehood

SRINAGAR

J&K CM Omar Abdullah on Friday moved a resolution on the restoration of Statehood “in continuation of the 2000 autonomy resolution” and evoked protests from the Opposition BJP MLAs, who tore the resolution and opposed any move to discuss Article 370 in the Assembly. » **Page 11**



CENSUS 2027

Method to sort caste
data yet to be decidedNEWS » **PAGE 11**

WFI CASE

4 wrestlers challenge
Brij Bhushan's acquittalNEWS » **PAGE 12**

THE WAIT ENDS

Suruchi, Kamaljeet
win first shooting goldSPORT » **PAGE 17**Congress leads protests
seeking CEC's exit, arrest

Modi and Shah using Kumar to overcome public opposition through 'artificial manipulation', says Venugopal; Congress demands reversal of decisions taken by EC, including those related to SIR



Raising concerns: Youth Congress workers staging a demonstration demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar in New Delhi on Friday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Friday led nationwide protests demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar, accusing him of compromising the integrity of India's electoral process, with the party's general secretary (organisation), K.C. Venugopal, seeking Mr. Kumar's resignation and arrest for alleged electoral malpractice.

Civil society groups and other organisations held parallel protests in Delhi and several States.

Congress workers took to the streets across the country, with protests in several places being stopped by the police. Water cannons were used against demonstrators in

Patna, Lucknow, and Punjab, while protesters were detained in Assam, Jammu, Odisha, Manipur, and other States. In Manipur's capital, Imphal, the police fired a few tear-gas shells to disperse the protesters.

In Kerala's Malappuram, Mr. Venugopal said the nationwide protests would continue until the CEC stepped down. Targeting Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah, the Congress leader alleged that they were using Mr. Kumar to overcome public opposition to the government through “artificial manipulation”.

“Resigning alone is not enough; he must be arrested. What he did is a criminal offence; he must be arrested,” Mr. Venugopal said, adding that all decisions taken by Mr. Kumar,

including those relating to the special intensive revision, should be revoked.

In a post on X, he urged every Indian to mount “unbelievable pressure on the regime and its puppet for the daylight robbery of our vote and fix accountability”.

The party's communication chief, Jairam Ramesh, said citizens and Congress workers hit the streets demanding accountability over the capture of their fundamental right to vote and the “Chief Election Commissioner's diabolical mischief”.

“The frightened Modi Govt. has cracked down on protesters and detained Congress leaders and workers, young citizens and students, and civil society activists – in so many places across the country,” he wrote on X.

Congress leader Pawan Khhera told a press conference: “We want to say to Gyanesh Kumar: it's done, bro. Heed Rahul Gandhi's advice – resign and turn approver.”

The Congress accused the Election Commission of an “unprecedented attack” on voter equality, alleging that a specific ‘Mark VIP’ feature had been created in the BLO application.

Amid mounting pressure from the Opposition, Mr. Kumar cancelled two scheduled meetings in Uttar Pradesh. Poll body sources said these were not linked to the protests and were routine decisions.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 10**

RELATED REPORTS ON
» **PAGE 10**

Union govt., banks to decide subsidy
amount for UPI after charges kick in

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

The Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on UPI transactions will not be enough to cover the cost of running and maintaining the payment platform, and so the government will soon hold discussions with the Indian Banks' Association (IBA) to decide what quantum of the ongoing government subsidy should continue and in what form, sources in the Ministry of Finance have confirmed.

The Ministry of Finance will also coordinate with the IBA on how to ensure that merchants do not pass on the MDR charge to customers. The MDR charge will go live on UPI on October 15, and there is no proposal to delay this date, the sources said.

The government has budgeted ₹2,000 crore for the ongoing financial year under its incentive scheme for the promotion of RuPay

debit cards and low-value BHIM-UPI transactions.

Talks with IBA

“The MDR amount that will be collected will not be enough to cover the full cost of UPI,” a senior official in the Ministry said on condition of anonymity.

“As for the incentive the government is already providing, we will need to discuss with the IBA on how much should continue and how... We will also be speaking to the IBA in the run-up to October 15 to work out ways in which it can be ensured that the merchants do not pass on the MDR to customers,” the official added.

Separately, the Finance Ministry will also be speaking to traders and their umbrella body, the Confederation of All India Traders (CAIT), to explain the MDR charge to them and explain how most merchants will not be affected, and so should not stop accepting

UPI payments.

Issue for GST Council

Another official said that the Ministry could not “unilaterally” decide on the issue of a levy of Goods and Services Tax on the MDR amount collected by payment processors and banks from merchants.

“UPI is a service, and the MDR is the charge for providing that service to merchants,” the second official explained. “As such, that service is taxed under GST. But it is for the GST Council to decide on the rate, how much, whether to exempt and all that. The Centre cannot unilaterally take those actions.”

The second official, however, clarified that the upcoming GST Council meeting on October 7 will be related to process reforms rather than “any sort of rate issue”.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 10**

Union Minister says
SC/ST MPs not given
enough time to speak

EXCLUSIVE

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

Union Minister Jitan Ram Manjhi, in a letter addressed to Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla, has said that MPs belonging to the Scheduled Castes (SCs) and Scheduled Tribes (STs) are not “given adequate time” to speak during discussions on important Bills in Parliament.

Mr. Manjhi heads the Hindustani Awam Morcha (Secular), an ally of the ruling National Democratic Alliance (NDA).

In his letter dated September 16, Mr. Manjhi referred to an “NDA sansad samooh samvaad baithak” (NDA MP Group Dialogue Meeting) held at his residence on August 5.

He said BJP Lok Sabha member Gajendra Singh Patel, who represents Khargone, a reserved tribal



Jitan Ram Manjhi

constituency in Madhya Pradesh, had pointed out that MPs from SC/ST communities were not given adequate time to speak during discussions on important Bills in Parliament. Mr. Manjhi urged the Lok Sabha Speaker to take steps to rectify it.

Mr. Patel, speaking to *The Hindu* over the phone from Khargone, said this was a sentiment expressed by many MPs and not by him alone. He also insisted that it was an “informal” recommendation.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 10**

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UNIVERSITY

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Judge, High Court of Andhra Pradesh

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Head - Academic Alliances Group
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Dr. G. Viswanathan

Founder & Chancellor



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2 DU students held for harassing women in Mukherjee Nagar

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Two Delhi University (DU) students were arrested on Friday in connection with the FIR registered after two women students of Hindu College alleged that a group of men harassed them and tried to pull them into a car in north-west Delhi's Mukherjee Nagar on Wednesday. The incident occurred two days after the alleged gang rape at Astha Kunj Park.

Deputy Commissioner of Police (North West) Akansha Yadav said the accused have been identified as Abhinav and Abhimanyu and the SUV used in the incident has been

seized. Efforts are on to apprehend Naman, another DU student and driver of the vehicle, and the other accused involved in the case, the officer added.

The women had stated in their complaint that the group of men in a white SUV had approached them while on a walk in Mukherjee Nagar and passed lewd remarks at them. When they objected and asked the men to leave, the accused allegedly abused them and continued following them in the SUV. The men allegedly tried to pull them into the vehicle, but fled when they saw one of the women take out her phone to record the incident, the complaint stated.

Delhi BJP in-charge takes charge, targets win in 2027 MCD poll

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Newly appointed in-charge of Delhi BJP Vinay Sahasrabudhe on Friday took charge at the State unit office and asserted that the party will contest the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) polls next year with "full confidence".

Mr. Sahasrabudhe, a former Rajya Sabha MP, is credited with BJP's victory in the 2017 polls. "There are high expectations from the BJP as we have a government in Delhi and at the Centre," he said.

The last MCD elections

in 2022 resulted in a loss for the BJP, which was defeated by the Aam Aadmi Party. The next elections, covering 250 wards, will take place next year.

After paying floral tributes to key party ideologue Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya on his birth anniversary, Mr. Sahasrabudhe held a meeting with Delhi unit president Harsh Malhotra, and general secretaries Pawan Rana, Vishnu Mittal, Yogita Singh, and Mohan Lal Gihara. "Together, we will work towards achieving a major victory in the 2027 MCD polls," he said.

‘What steps are you taking?': HC questions DU over hostel shortage, flags ‘vague’ reply

Court notes only 5,698 of over 1.3 lakh students have hostel access, while hearing petitions on the Satya Niketan tragedy; cause of collapse unknown, downpour may have weakened structure: MCD

Soibam Rocky Singh
NEW DELHI

The Delhi High Court on Friday criticised Delhi University over its response on the issue of adding additional hostel facilities for students as "absolutely vague" while hearing various petitions on the September 6 Satya Niketan multi-storey building collapse in which seven persons, including five students, lost their lives.

The court made stern remarks on the question of building new hostels for students.

A counsel for one of the petitioners pointed out that DU's affidavit showed that only 5,698 students were being provided hostel accommodation, even as nearly 1.3 lakh students regularly attend classes. The Bench of Chief Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia then stated: "You (DU) are only giving figures, as against the students' strength of more than a lakh, you are giving hostel facilities to a few thousand. And then you say that you are taking steps. What are those steps?"

"From which corner are you not getting cooperation? Tell us," it added.

The DU counsel said the university would file a "better affidavit".

During the proceedings, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the

Safety check

Only 30% of the 2,453 PG buildings inspected by the MCD after the September 6 tragedy had sanctioned building plans. Hundreds of properties have faced action for unauthorised construction, it told the HC



Aftermath: Rescue teams working at the site in Satya Niketan on September 6. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

Five officers across the entire supervisory chain of the municipal corporation, including a Deputy Commissioner, have been placed under suspension

TUSHAR MEHTA, Solicitor General, appearing for the MCD

SOURCE: MUNICIPAL CORPORATION OF DELHI

civic agency and the Delhi police, shared details of the action taken by the MCD and the police following the collapse.

Multiple inquiries

He said the Delhi government had commissioned a magisterial inquiry to look into the incident, as well as issues such as the validity of permissions, compliance with building by-laws and the role of the concerned officials.

The Delhi government had also constituted a high-

powered committee on student accommodation and safety to examine issues relating to student accommodation and safety in Delhi and to recommend appropriate, time-bound measures, Mr. Mehta added.

On the Satya Niketan tragedy, the MCD said the exact cause of the collapse could not be ascertained. It, however, said that the downpour before September 6 "could have weakened" the old structure. The civic agency added

that it had carried out a detailed inspection of about 300 properties in the students' hub and found 101 housing PGs.

PGs vacated

"Of these, three properties were declared dangerous, and the PGs in them were vacated. Ten properties were identified as vulnerable and requiring major repairs, while 14 were found to require minor repairs," the MCD told the court, which listed the matter for hearing on October 14.



Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Around 30 people were rescued after a fire broke out in a multi-storey building housing a Haldiram's outlet and other establishments in north-west Delhi's Model Town on Friday, officials said.

The fire broke out around 2 p.m., following which Head Constable Pawan, the beat officer of Model Town police station, alerted senior officers and began rescue efforts, the police said.

Thick smoke was seen billowing from the building, which has a basement, ground floor and three upper floors.

The Delhi Fire Services (DFS) received a call about the blaze around 2.40 p.m. and initially rushed four fire tenders to the spot. As the fire intensified, 23 units, including a hydraulic platform, were deployed.

The police evacuated occupants from the affected building and adjoining structures, rescuing around 30 people.

No injuries or casualties

were reported.

"The building has a basement, ground and three floors. On the ground and first floor there is Haldiram's and on second and third floor there is one more restaurant. The fire was in all the floors. We have searched the entire building and no one was trapped inside," a DFS officer said.

The fire, suspected to have been caused by a short circuit, was classified as a medium fire at 3.30 p.m. and brought under control around 4 p.m., the officer said.

Md. Sajid, an assistant bank manager at a private bank, said the occupants were alerted by a security guard.

"As soon as the short circuit happened, the guard informed us that fire has broken out and we should evacuate the building. The fire started from the ground floor and engulfed the whole building. We used fire extinguisher in our office to try to extinguish fire as much as we could on an individual level," he said.

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LEGAL NOTICE

COURT NOTICE
Dist: Hooghly
In the Court of Ld. District Delegate at Chandernagore Act XXXIX Case No. 52 of 2021 Anjan Chatterjee @ Shaila ChatterjeePetitioner
Notice Through Publication
To
a) Prasenjit Mukherjee
e) Priyajit Mukherjee
Both are of D-19, Sector 50, Noida, Uttarpradesh-201301.

Whereas, the above named Petitioner has filed the above noted Act XXXIX Case for granting Probate in respect of last WILL of Late Namita Debi @ Namita Chatterjee, wife of Late- Arindora Chatterjee, of Ferry Ghat Street, P.O.- Telinipara, P.S. Bhadreswar, Dist.- Hooghly, PIN-721255. The above named addressee are the near relatives (grandsons) of deceased Namita Debi @ Namita Chatterjee. In spite of sending Notice you have failed to appear before the Ld. Court to answer in respect of the claim of the Petitioner. You are hereby directed to appear before the Ld. Court within 30 days from the date of Publication of this Notice failing of which the case will run ex-parte against you in accordance with law.

By Order
Chanchal Biswas
Sheristadar,
District Delegate
Chandernagore
Arup Sarkar
Advocate
Petitioner's Advocate

LEGAL NOTICE

IN THE COURT OF Sh. Deepanker Mohan District Judge-04 (Shahdara District) Room No. 306, 3rd Floor, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi-110032
YOGENDER KUMAR JAIN V/S THE STATE
NEXT DATE: 02/11/2026
1. YOGENDER KUMAR JAIN S/O RAMSHYAM DAVLA JAIN R/O C-13 AND 14, VIKAS VIHAR PHASE-I, EAST DELHI, DELHI-110095
...PETITIONER
VERSUS
1. THE STATE THROUGH SDM, VIKAS VIHAR, OFFICE OF THE SUB-DIVISIONAL MAGISTRATE (VIKAS VIHAR) GROUND, 11th FLOOR, DC OFFICE COMPLEX, NANG NAGRI OPPOSITE GAGAN CINEMA, DELHI-110093
2. ARUN KUMAR JAIN C/O DEEPA JAIN R/O C-14, VIKAS VIHAR PHASE-I, EAST DELHI, VIKAS VIHAR, PO JHILMI, DIST. SHAHDARA, DELHI-110095
3. RITA JAIN W/O SUDHIR JAIN R/O A-69, SECTOR 39, NOIDA, GAUTAM BUDDHA, NAGAR, UTTAR PRADESH-201301
...RESPONDENTS
Citation for publication of petition Under Section 278 of the Indian Succession Act, 1925 for Grant of Letter of Administration in respect of the Estate of Late Smt. Jaima Jain of the property A-15, Jhilmil Industrial Area, Delhi in accordance to the last WILL of Late Smt. Jaima Jain dated 21.05.2015 in favour of petitioner.
Whereas the date 02.11.2026 has been fixed for hearing of the case, notice is hereby given that person having any interest in the said petition concerned may if he/she desire appear in this Court on 02.11.2026 at 10 am and see the proceedings.
GIVEN under my hand and the seal of this court.
District Judge-04
Shahdara District
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi-110032

IN THE COURT OF Sh. Deepanker Mohan District Judge-04 (Shahdara District) Room No. 306, 3rd Floor, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi-110032
RAJENDER SINGH V/S THE STATE
NEXT DATE: 04/10/2026
1. RAJENDER SINGH R/O H.NO. A-245, GALI NO.2, HARSH VIHAR, DELHI-93
2. MANPAL SINGH R/O H.NO. A-245, GALI NO.2, HARSH VIHAR, DELHI-93
3. SUNDER PAL R/O A-8, TAKSHASHILA APARTMENT, EXTENSION, PATIPALAN, DELHI-110092
...RESPONDENTS
VERSUS
1. THE STATE (JCT OF DELHI)
2. BINDER SINGH R/O H.NO. A-244, STREET NO. 2, HARSH VIHAR, DELHI-93
3. SMT. RAJESHWARI DEVI R/O WARD NO. 1, NEAR KANAL FACTORY, JHOK RE PASS AND SWATHI BAI PRULE SCHOOL, SAL NAGAR, R VIKAS NAGAR, LONI, GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH-201102
4. SMT. LOKESH W/O INDERPAL R/O B-17/20A, GALI NO. 9, HARSH VIHAR, DELHI-110095
5. SMT. BRIJESH W/O PREETAM W/O PREETAM R/O 14/127, RAM NAGAR EXTENSION, SHAHDARA, DELHI-110032
6. SMT. SUDHA W/O RAJINDER R/O 380, POCKET-E, DILSHAD GARDEN, OPP. GREEN FIELD PUBLIC SCHOOL, DELHI-110095
...RESPONDENTS
Citation for publication of petition Under Section 278 of the Indian Succession Act, 1925 for Grant of Letter of Administration in respect of Will Dated 26.11.2026. Assesed by Late Smt. Prem Devi W/Late Sh. Daya R/o A-245, GALI NO.2, Harsh Vihar, Delhi-110095.
Whereas the date 14.10.2026 has been fixed for hearing of the case, notice is hereby given that person having any interest in the said petition concerned may if he/she desire appear in this Court on 14.10.2026 at 10 am and see the proceedings.
GIVEN under my hand and the seal of this court.
District Judge-04, Shahdara District
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi-110032

OFFICE OF SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
CONSTRUCTION CIRCLE,
U.P. JAL NIGAM (URBAN)
R-1, Sector-1 In Front of New Railway Station, Rajnagar, Ghaziabad - 201002 (U.P.)
E-Mail:- se18upjn@yahoo.co.in

E-TENDER NOTICE
U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) invites E-bids for execution of "Investigation, Survey (On G.I.S. Basis) & Construction of Interception & Diversion works with treatment facilities alongwith treated effluent line etc. in various zone of, in Patla Nagar Panchayat, Distt- Ghaziabad under SBM-(U)- 2.0 Programme".
Bids are invited in two bid system on percentage basis from eligible, reputed and experienced bidders.

E-tender document will be available for download from dated 26.09.2026 from 05:00 PM. Pre-bid meeting will be held on dated 03.10.2026 at 03:00 PM in the office of undersigned. E-bids can be submitted till 12.10.2026 up to 05:00 PM and technical bid shall be opened on 13.10.2026 at 3:45 PM in the office of Superintending Engineer, Construction Circle, U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban), Ghaziabad in presence of contractors or their authorized representatives. E-tender Cost is Rs. 10,000.00+ GST @ 18% for tender. The tender document & details are available on U.P. Govt. e-procurement portal http://etender.up.nic.in & U.P.J.N. (Urban) website www.jn.upscdc.gov.in.

Timings

SATURDAY, SEP. 26		
RISE	06:11	SET 18:13
RISE	17:54	SET 05:36
SUNDAY, SEP. 27		
RISE	06:12	SET 18:12
RISE	18:25	SET 06:36
MONDAY, SEP. 28		
RISE	06:12	SET 18:11
RISE	19:00	SET 07:39

Delhi Weather	max	min
Delhi City	36	25
Safdarjang	36	25
Palam	35	24

Delhi Palam Today
35°C Morning will be pleasant with mist and haze. The weather will be dry. Day will be warm with uneasy afternoon. Night will be comfortable.

Delhi Palam Tomorrow
36°C The dry weather to continue. Day will be very warm and uneasy. Night will remain comfortable.

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THE HINDU
India's National Newspaper

Ganesh Chaturthi: loud sounds leave animals at zoo unsettled

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

As drums rolled and music blared from loudspeakers during Ganpati immersion processions in south-east Delhi on Friday, the noise also reached the National Zoological Park along Mathura Road, with officials acknowledging that loud sounds can unsettle animals.

The concern is compounded by the absence of designated routes for immersion processions. Traffic officials said devotees may choose any route to reach the seven artificial ponds in the district or Kalindi Kunj.

Mathura Road, about 100 metres from the animal enclosures at its closest point, is among the arterial roads used by processions.

A senior zoo official said solitary animals, particularly tigers, were more sensitive to such disturbances.

"Carnivores, particularly tigers, and others who stay outdoors, are very sensitive to these noises and can get triggered," the official said.

Gauri Maulekhi, trustee of NGO People for Animals, said loud noise triggers a panic response in animals. "What we see as celebration can be perceived by them as an immediate threat to life," she said.

The zoo was closed to visitors on Friday and the animals were already inside their cells.

Loudspeakers require written permission under the Noise Pollution Rules, 2000, which also prescribe ambient noise limits.



CM Rekha Gupta taking a selfie with commuters during the flag-off ceremony of a metro train on Friday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

CM says govt. has met the target of planting 70 lakh saplings under green drive

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Friday said the Delhi government had achieved its target of planting 70 lakh saplings under 'Mission Green Delhi'. The initiative was launched on July 7 by Union Home Minister Amit Shah.

The campaign saw participation from government departments, local bodies, schools, colleges, residents' welfare associations (RWAs), NGOs and citizens, according to the Chief Minister's Office (CMO).

Ms. Gupta said the achievement was the result of sustained efforts to expand Delhi's green cover and strengthen its ecosystem. "The government's aim is to build a city where development and environmental protection move forward together," she said.

Special plantation drives were carried out in the Central Ridge, DDA Ridge and South Ridge areas, where 24,94,505 saplings were planted.

The campaign also saw public participation through a slot-booking facility, which received 1,89,116 bookings. Of these, 1,47,095 citizens participated in the drive and planted 3,56,986 saplings, the CMO stated.

Ms. Gupta said the next phase of the campaign would focus on ensuring the survival and growth of the saplings and appealed to citizens to regularly nurture and protect the plants.

Environment Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa said the participation of citizens, RWAs, students, NGOs and other institutions had turned the campaign into a people's movement. (With inputs from PTI)

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OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

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Dr. Kumar Akhilesh
(D.O.B: 05.01.1975 - D.O.D: 25.9.2026)
our Director, Colleague, Mentor and Friend, whose remarkable contributions to Indian prehistoric archaeology and heritage education will be remembered with great respect. We extend our heartfelt condolences to his family, colleagues, students and all who had the privilege of knowing him.
Phone: 8087810331

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

First Year Death Anniversary

DOB: 20.06.1941 DOD: 26.09.2025
S.R. RADHAKRISHNAN, M.A.(S.W)
Retd. Zonal Director, Ministry of Labour, Govt. Of India.
A social worker by education, an entrepreneur at heart, a progressive in his home and a farmer in his soul.
You have planted a seed in each one of us which will live on forever.
Deeply missed and remembered by
Ravi, Madhan, Manju, Sushma, Uma, Suren, Shruti, Shreya, Shweta, Darshan, Arjun
and the rest of your family, relatives, friends & employees of
JANATHA TRANSPORT
Selamanatham, Vellore, 632319

"Inviting Online Bids"

The Executive Engineer, Jal Shakti Division Larji invites online tenders on short time basis on behalf of Government or Himachal Pradesh from approved eligible contractors for the following works through e-tendering process:-

Job. No.	Name of Work:	Estimated Cost	EMD Cost of Tender	Time of completion (months)	Cost of form
1.	Restoration of Rain Damages to LIS Balagad Chether and Khabbal in Tehsil Banjar Distt Kullu (H.P) (SH- Providing and installation of Raw water Mono Block pump set , Installation of centrifugal pumping machinery 475 HP = 1set along with its allied accessories , Repair of existing Rising main 450 mm dia and C/O Anchor block) Under PDNA (Balance Work)	5013224	100264	3 months	2000
2.	Restoration of Rain Damages to WSS Neoli in G.P. Deoridhar in Tehsil Sainj Distt Kullu (H.P)(SH- Repair of pipe line by Providing laying jointing and testing of HDPE pipes line from spring source Neoli, Keulidhar village and adjoining area at various RD's) Under SDF	188062	3761	2 months	350
3.	Restoration of Rain Damages to WSS Phatti Shansher (Phase Tungah & Dharta) in G.P. Deoridhar in Tehsil Sainj Distt Kullu (H.P) (SH- Repair of pipe line by Providing laying jointing and testing of HDPE pipes line from spring source Nagoli to village Tungah, Dharta and adjoining area at various RD's) Under SDF	199542	3991	2 months	350

Last date submission of tender :- 03-10-2026 upto 11:00 AM and opened on 03-10-2026 upto to 11:30 AM

The tender forms/NIT and other detailed conditions can be downloaded from the website www.hpiph.org or from office of the Executive Engineer upto date specified above.

HIMSUNCHNA AVAM JANSAMPARK

**Executive Engineer
Jal Shakti Division
Larji**

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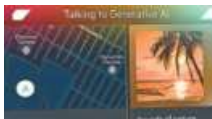
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A ND-NDE

IIT-B student death case: Crime Branch records statements

National Commission for Scheduled Castes holds inquiry after allegations of caste-based harassment; Athwale demands independent investigation

Chinmay Gaikwad
MUMBAI

The Mumbai police's Crime Branch has recorded the statements of 20 people in connection with the alleged death by suicide of IIT Bombay student Sahil Ravindra Wakode. The institute had initially claimed that he was caught cheating during an exam.

Among those questioned so far are students, staff members, those present in the examination hall, teachers supervising the examination, and hostel staff, officials said.

The officials are also trying to access his locked mobile phone. "His mobile phone was secured with a pattern lock, restricting access," said an officer.

National Commission for Scheduled Castes Chairman Kishor Makwana conducted an inquiry on the campus after allegations from the student's family regarding caste-based discrimination.

Minister of State of Social Justice and Empowerment Ramdas Athawale



The parents of Sahil Ravindra Wakode protesting along with people demanding justice in the case at Azad Maidan in Mumbai. ANI

too visited the campus on Friday. He demanded an independent investigation into the death of Wakode. Mr. Athawale, a prominent Dalit leader, met IIT Bombay director and senior officials.

Mr. Athawale said he will write to Union Education Minister Pralhad Joshi to seek a meeting. He added that he demanded action against former Dean Suryanarayana Doolla.

According to Mr. Athawale, Mr. Doolla confiscated the student's mobile phone during the examination on September 18. The former Dean raised an

objection against the student, alleging copying. Mr. Athawale demanded that Mr. Doolla be suspended.

Past incidents

The Minister also pointed out that four students had died by suicide at the institute in the last two to three years, and three of them were from the Scheduled Caste community.

Wakode, a second-year B'Tech student belonging to the Scheduled Caste, allegedly ended his life on campus on September 18. *(Those in distress can contact Tele MANAS at 14416 to seek help)*

M.P. gets govt. bus service after 21 years; 351 buses flagged off

Mehul Malpani
BHOPAL

Union Minister for Road Transport and Highways Nitin Gadkari and Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav relaunched public bus service in the State on Friday. The service was shutdown in 2005 and the relaunch came after a gap of 21 years.

At a ceremony held on the birth anniversary of Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) patron Deen Dayal Upadhyay, Mr. Yadav and Mr. Gadkari unveiled the 'Mukhyamantri Sugam Parivahan Seva' and flagged off 351 buses to be operated from seven cities, from Bhopal's BHEL Dussehra ground. The service has been launched under the Madhya Pradesh's Mobility Vision - 2030.

The cities that will start operations under phase-I are Indore, Bhopal, Jabalpur, Rewa, Dewas, Katni and Bhind with 231 intra-city and 120 inter-city buses.

As per official information, the government plans to run 1,500 in the first year and add 2,500-3,000 buses every year. Overall, the government plans to run 15,000 intra-State and inter-State buses across 3,500 routes by 2031, and targets to connect 75% gram panchayats across



Union Minister Nitin Gadkari and M.P. CM Mohan Yadav during the launch of the bus service in Bhopal on Friday. ANI

the State.

Speaking at the event, Mr. Yadav said the buses will provide a modern, affordable and safe mode of travel for the public.

Mr. Yadav and Mr. Gadkari also launched the 'PM e-bus Sewa' in the State. Mr. Gadkari said the Centre plans to deploy 10,000 electric buses at a cost of ₹57,000 crore under the scheme, of which ₹20,000 crore will be borne by the Centre. "A total of 972 buses have been sanctioned in M.P. so far," he added.

Congress State unit president Jitu Patwari said, "The government is taking 10-year-old buses out of the scrapyard, refurbishing them with new paint and bodywork, and putting them back on the road – only to tout this as a major achievement. It must tell the actual condition of the buses being deployed."

Why different rules for Karnataka in release of Central aid: Khandre

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Rural Development and Panchayat Raj Minister Eshwar B. Khandre on Friday questioned the Centre's decision to withhold ₹2,186.20 crore in grants due to Karnataka under the 15th Finance Commission, alleging that the State was being subjected to conditions not applied to Assam, Bihar, Gujarat and Uttarakhand.

Responding to questions on the financial position of gram panchayats, Mr. Khandre attributed the shortage of funds to what he termed the Centre's discriminatory approach towards Karnataka.

Under the Finance Commission recommendations, grants meant for gram panchayats are released by the Centre to the State, which is required to transfer them to the panchayats within 10 days. The receipt details are to be uploaded on the e-Gram Swaraj portal, failing which



Karnataka Rural Development and Panchayat Raj Minister Eshwar Khandre. FILE PHOTO

the amount is required to be paid with interest, he said.

He said Karnataka had received ₹2,133.25 crore for gram panchayats in 2024-25, while receipts amounting to ₹1,907 crore had been reflected on the e-Gram Swaraj portal. The difference of about ₹225 crore was due to technical issues and the funds had reached gram panchayats and been utilised for works, he said. "Citing such a minor issue as a reason for withholding ₹2,186 crore is an injustice to Karnataka," he said.

He cited the release of

funds to other States to question the Centre's approach. Uttarakhand, he said, had received ₹470 crore for 2025-26 despite no receipts being reflected on the portal. Similarly, Gujarat had received ₹2,619 crore, while receipts of ₹2,104 crore were reflected on the portal, leaving a difference of ₹515 crore. Assam had received ₹1,315 crore against portal receipts of ₹447 crore, while Bihar had received ₹4,109 crore against receipts of ₹1,775 crore.

He said other States had received funds despite discrepancies between allocations and receipts reflected on the portal. "Why is a condition that is not being applied to Assam, Bihar, Gujarat and Uttarakhand being applied only to Karnataka?" he asked.

He alleged that the Centre was following a "discriminatory policy" and said the State had been denied funds due to it under the Finance Commission recommendations.

BJP built narrative ahead of Bengal poll via YouTubers: TMC

Shiv Sahay Singh
Senjuti Sengupta
KOLKATA

The Trinamool Congress (TMC) on Friday accused the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) of manufacturing a narrative of religious polarisation by paying YouTubers and social media influencers ahead of the West Bengal Assembly polls.

According to expenditure statements filed with the Election Commission, the BJP spent ₹286.99 crore on the West Bengal Assembly election. With details of the expenditure now in public domain, names of several YouTubers, who received money from the BJP, have surfaced.

Speaking to mediapersons outside the West Bengal Assembly, TMC MLA Kunal Ghosh referred to a particular YouTubers who created a flutter over social media alleging that he was served beef instead of mutton at a Kolkata restaurant. "There is a difference

With details of ruling party's expenditure now in the public domain, the names of several YouTubers have surfaced

between a media house and a YouTube channel. Through their platforms [YouTube channels], they have constantly been pulling down TMC's image. But now, EC's report made it clear that they did it for money. They were paid to create a manufactured narrative against us," he said.

Demanding investigation into the conduct of these YouTubers, Mr. Ghosh said that these influencers pretended to be journalists while executing these paid assignments, which raises a serious question about the media in public eye.

In the polls, the BJP defeated the TMC by winning 207 of 293 seats for which results were declared. The TMC was reduced to 80 Assembly seats.

2026 monsoon in Odisha likely to be wettest since 2000

The Hindu Bureau
BHUBANESWAR

The 2026 monsoon appears to be exceptionally wet in Odisha, with the State receiving 1,453.1 mm of rainfall between June 1 and September 25.

With five days left for the monsoon season to end, 2026 could emerge as the wettest monsoon year since 2000, if the State receives more than average 33.1 mm of rainfall during the remaining period, said Manorama Mohanty, Director of the India Meteorological Department's

Bhubaneswar centre.

"As on September 25, Odisha received 29% excess rainfall. During this monsoon, heavy rainfall was triggered by 11 weather systems, including low-pressure areas and depressions, that formed over the Bay of Bengal," she said.

"Of the 11 atmospheric systems that brought rainfall, the current deep depression triggered the highest rainfall," Ms Mohanty said.

Meanwhile, the southern Odisha districts received heavy rainfall on Friday.

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6	Joint Director (Law)	01	Level-13	₹1,23,100–2,15,900
7	Dy. Director (Tariff – Economics)	01	Level-11	₹67,700–2,08,700
8	Dy. Director (Tariff) –Accounts & Finance Analysis	01	Level-11	₹67,700–2,08,700
9	Dy. Director (Law)	01	Level-11	₹67,700–2,08,700
10	Joint Secretary	01	Level-11	₹67,700–2,08,700
11	Dy. Director (Consumer Assistance)	01	Level-11	₹67,700–2,08,700
12	Principal Private Secretary	02	Level-11	₹67,700–2,08,700
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INBRIEF



Security strengthened ahead of Sabarimala pilgrimage

Keralam Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala has said that extensive arrangements will be put in place to ensure the safety of pilgrims during the upcoming Sabarimala pilgrimage. The Minister chaired a high-level meeting on Friday to review preparations by the police. He said that social media campaigns would be organised in regional languages while signboards and public announcement systems would be installed at key locations to provide information to pilgrims.

Karnataka set to launch adventure tourism initiative

With the aim of providing sports enthusiasts a platform to participate in adventure sports while exploring various tourism destinations, the Karnataka Tourism Department will launch ‘Active Karnataka - Run, Ride, Surf and Explore’ on September 27 on the occasion of World Tourism Day. The Tourism department will enter into an agreement with leading sports event organisers and connect them with nearby tourism destinations.

ED summons Telangana MLA in money-laundering probe

The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has summoned Telangana’s Serilingampally MLA Arekapudi Gandhi for questioning, as part of its money-laundering probe into Sahiti Infratec Ventures India Private Limited (SIVIPL). Around ₹2.1 crore from the company was allegedly found to have been routed through the MLA’s bank accounts. The ED issued summons asking Mr. Gandhi to appear before the agency on Monday.

Keralam urges Centre to limit eco-sensitive areas to forests

State govt. submits recommendations seeking resetting of ESA in Western Ghats; populated areas, farmlands and plantations should be excluded from the notification, says Minister

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The Keralam government has urged the Centre to limit the Ecologically Sensitive Area (ESA) in its Western Ghats region to forest areas covering 8,590.69 sq. km.

M.G. Rajamanickam, Special Secretary, Environment and Climate Change, formally placed the State’s recommendations and suggestions before the Centre on Thursday, Minister for Electricity and Environment Sunny Joseph said in Thiruvananthapuram on Friday. “Our stand is that populated areas, farmlands and plantations should be excluded and the ESA limited to forest re-



A view of the Kootickal village in Kottayam district, which has been included in the draft ESA notification. VISHNU PRATHAP

gions,” Mr. Joseph said. In 2013, the K. Kasturirangan Committee had proposed an ESA of 13,108 sq. km covering 123 villages in the State. This had sparked widespread protests. Following a study, the Union Ministry of Environ-

ment and Forests had issued a draft notification that reduced the area to 9,993.7 sq. km. The State wants the ESA to be brought down to 8,590.69 sq. km and the number of villages to 98.

‘Unique’ case Keralam’s case was “unique” given its small size but dense population and large forest cover (29.15% of total area), he said. The addition of another law to the existing stringent laws protecting the forest, environment, paddy fields and wetlands could adversely affect the State’s development, agriculture and the everyday life of the people, the Minister added.

If needed, Chief Minis-

EC rejects BJP MLA’s plea to scrutinise 2,598 votes in Karnataka constituency

The Hindu Bureau
BELAGAVI

The Election Commission of India (EC) officials in charge of the special intensive revision (SIR) have rejected BJP leader and MLA Abhay Patil’s demand for scrutiny and deletion of around 2,598 votes in Karnataka’s Belagavi North constituency.

M. Karthik, Belagavi City Corporation Commissioner and the Electoral

Registration Officer (ERO) has replied to the MLA’s letter, saying that there was no legal provision for bulk scrutiny or deletion of votes under the SIR process. He, however, clarified that Booth Level Agents (BLAs) could file objections to the inclusion of doubtful electors through the Booth Level Officers (BLOs).

In a letter dated September 19, Mr. Patil had alleged that BLAs from his constituency had identified over

2,598 suspected bogus voters. He had submitted details of the suspected voters, along with their part numbers and booth numbers, and sought scrutiny of their entries.

B.K. Hariprasad, MLC and KPCC president, had objected to Mr. Patil’s move, arguing that the MLA had no *locus standi* to write to SIR officials seeking bulk deletion of voters. He alleged that the MLA was targeting Muslim vo-

ters to further his prospects in the next election.

Speaking to reporters in Belagavi on Friday, Mr. Patil said he had not sought bulk deletion of voters.

“I have not asked for deletion of the names of any elector. I am only asking SIR officers to look into allegations of inclusion of bogus voters, scrutinise Forms 6 and 7 submitted by suspect voters and delete their names if found false...,” he said.

BJP leader hits out at ‘bhajan jamming’ session at Badrinath

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

Amid controversy over a loud, concert-style “bhajan jamming” session held during a two-day cultural festival near the Badrinath shrine in Uttarakhand, veteran Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) leader Murli Manohar Joshi on Friday criticised the act and termed it a “violation of the shrine’s cultural traditions and religious sanctity”.

The cultural festival, organised under the theme “Our Heritage, Our Future”, was held on September 19 and 20 at the Tourist Arrival Plaza adjoining the temple in the fragile, high-altitude town.

The Chamoli district administration and the Uttarakhand Tourism Department claimed that the Army had organised the festival. Videos of the “bhajan jamming” session, centred on a performance by singer Priyanka Meher, went viral on social media.

Taking to social media platform X, Mr. Joshi said organising a loud musical event at the sacred Himalayan shrine amounted to an “assault on the faith” of millions of devotees. “It is noteworthy that this temple was established by Adi Guru Shankaracharya in the Himalayan environment for peaceful devotion through divine hymns... even blowing a conch shell is prohibited at this site, yet we disregarded this and organised a noisy music event, thereby gravely neglecting India’s spiritual, cultural, and environmen-



Murli Manohar Joshi

tal values,” he said.

Mr. Joshi added that allowing thousands to dance at such a high altitude ignored the adverse health impact on them as well.

Calling out the “transformation of Dev Bhoomi into a hub of commercial culture”, the BJP leader urged the Centre and the Uttarakhand government to prohibit such events and preserve the spiritual character of the State.

‘Deep blow to faith’ “The Himalayas are divine, the abode of Lord Shiva and the origin of Mother Ganga. Turning this sacred land into a dance venue is a deep blow to the faith of crores of Indians,” he stated in his post.

Earlier, Swami Avimukteshwaranand Saraswati, Shankaracharya of Jyotirmath, had demanded a ban on “vulgar performances” near the Badrinath temple, which is part of the annual Char Dham Yatra.

Local stakeholders and Opposition Congress leaders also questioned the appropriateness of “concert-style entertainment at one of Hinduism’s most revered pilgrimage sites”.

Chargesheet in Muttill tree-felling case revised

The Hindu Bureau
KOZHIKODE

The Forest department in Keralam has resubmitted the chargesheet in the Muttill tree-felling case after rectifying the shortcomings that had prompted the Judicial First Class Magistrate Court-I, Sulthan Bathery, to return the earlier document. The revised chargesheet was submitted on Friday.

The court had returned the chargesheet citing missing documents, clerical errors, and shortcomings in the confiscation proceedings concerning the vehicle allegedly used to transport the timber. It had also questioned the delay in filing the chargesheet, observing that the department had not submitted a petition requesting that the delay be condoned.

The court noted that the delay could have been explained by citing the time taken to obtain DNA test results and a government directive requiring forest cases to be filed after the police submitted chargesheets in connected criminal cases. The court had also flagged deficiencies in the investigation, including the failure to trace and produce the remnants of trees allegedly felled on forestland.

The latest submission came amid allegations that omissions in the earlier chargesheet could have benefited the accused, the Augustine brothers. The tree-felling episode had resulted in more than 170 cases being filed by the Forest, Police and Revenue departments. The Forest department alone had registered 52 cases against the Augustine brothers.

Wind-swept



Strong winds continue to lash coconut trees along the RK Beach in Visakhapatnam on Friday, a day after the deep depression crossed the north Andhra Pradesh coast. K.R. DEEPAK

Heavy showers triggered by depression claim four more lives in A.P.; toll rises to nine

The Hindu Bureau
BUTTAIGUDEM

Four more rain-related deaths were reported in Andhra Pradesh on Friday, taking the death toll during the heavy rain triggered by the deep depression over the Bay of Bengal to nine.

A 60-year-old man was washed away in a swelling stream near Kannapuram in Buttaigudem mandal of Eluru district late on Thursday night.

One person died and nine were injured when a fish-laden lorry overturned near Pathuru village in Eluru district.

Two siblings were electrocuted at Jatlapalem vil-

lage in the West Godavari district on Friday, pushing the total number of deaths by electrocution to seven.

Meanwhile, the North Coastal Andhra Pradesh region shifted into restoration mode on Friday. While flood fears continued to mount in Srikakulam, restoration and road-clearing operations gathered pace in Visakhapatnam and other affected areas.

The situation remained particularly critical in Srikakulam, where heavy inflows into the Nagavali, Vamsadhara and Bahuda rivers triggered flooding in low-lying areas.

Minister takes stock Home Minister V. Anitha reviewed the flood situation and directed officials to remain vigilant over the rising water levels.

The Minister asked them to coordinate closely with the authorities in Odisha to monitor flood flows, particularly from upstream areas, and take timely measures to protect people in vulnerable locations.

Court to give order on Reporter TV MD’s bail petition today

The Hindu Bureau
KOCHI

The Ernakulam Principal Sessions Court has postponed to Saturday its order on the anticipatory bail plea moved by Reporter TV managing director Anto Augustine in the case related to the alleged multi-crore fraud behind the failed bid to bring the Argentina football team, led by Lionel Messi, to Keralam. Having concluded arguments from both sides on Thursday, the court had reserved its order for Friday. However, the prosecution sought copies of the documents submitted by the de-

fence along with the anticipatory bail application, following which the order was postponed.

Mr. Augustine moved the application anticipating an imminent move to arrest him after the Special Investigation Team (SIT) probing the case carried out search operations at the headquarters of Reporter Broadcasting Private Limited and locations linked to him and his brothers last week. Incidentally, he was arrested and remanded in judicial custody by the Ex-cise after 67 litres of liquor were seized from his ancestral home in Wayanad. He has since secured bail from the High Court.

Consumer case backlog in Keralam rises by 76%; 26,668 cases pending, says report

Sarath Babu George
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Keralam’s consumer dispute redressal system is grappling with a mounting backlog, with 26,668 cases pending before the State and district consumer commissions, according to a status report submitted by the amicus curiae before the Supreme Court.

The report, filed recently in connection with a *suo moto* case concerning vacancies and inadequate infrastructure in consumer commissions in each State, reveals that the backlog before Keralam’s district commissions has surged by nearly 76% since December 2023, and was nearly twice that of Karna-



The findings raise concern over women’s representation in the State commission. GETTY IMAGES

taka and more than six times that of Tamil Nadu.

Of the total pending cases in Keralam, 22,270 were before district consumer commissions and 4,398 before the State Consumer Disputes Redressal Com-

mission, as of July 31.

Meanwhile, the State commission reported a reduction in its backlog from 4,505 cases at the end of 2025 to 4,398 by July 31, 2026. It disposed of 675 cases against 571 fresh filings within seven months this year.

The report also reveals that one of the cases pending before the Kerala State Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission dates back to December 11, 1995, making it one of the oldest pending consumer disputes in the country.

Female representation The report also highlights that two of the four sanctioned vacancies in the Kerala State Consumer Dis-

putes Redressal Commission remain unfilled.

The findings also raise concerns about women’s representation in the State commission. Citing the Consumer Justice Report, 2026, the amicus curiae observed that Keralam was among three States that did not have even one woman serving as a member or president.

The report also identified Keralam among the States where video-conferencing facilities were unavailable in district consumer commissions.

At the State commission level, however, Keralam reported 5,180 cases heard through video-conferencing between January and July 2026.

21-kg Balapur Ganesh laddu auctioned for ₹39 lakh

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

The famous Balapur Ganesh laddu, which weighed 21 kg, fetched a record ₹39 lakh at the annual auction on Friday with Sama Praneeth Reddy, founder of Urban Group Private Limited, placing the winning bid.

The auction has become one of the most anticipated events of the Ganesh festival in Hyderabad. It was held after the 18-foot-tall Ganesh idol was taken on a ceremonial tour through the lanes of Balapur. The auction traces its origins to 1994, when a similar offering was sold for ₹450.



वरीय परियोजना अभियंता का कार्यालय
**बिहार राज्य पुल निर्माण निगम लि०,
कार्य प्रमंडल आरा।**

http://brpnnl.bihar.gov.in ई-मेल e-mail : spe-ara@brpnn.co.in
Doc.No-BRPNL/ARA/ 869

(SHORT NOTICE INVITING FOR RFP)
(Only through e-tendering system on website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

The Bihar Rajya Pul Nirman Nigam Ltd (B.R.P.N.N.L.) invites online bids from eligible System Integrators empanelled with Indian Highway Management Company Limited (IHMC) **on Item rate basis** for Selection of System Integrator for Implementation of Electronic Toll Collection System Including Weigh-in-Motion & Static Weigh Bridge System at toll plaza mentioned below:

Sl. No.	Name of Work	Estimated Cost (in Rs. Cr.)	Bid Security (in Lakh)	Cost of RFP (in Rs.)	Bid Processing Fee	Contract Period
1	Selection of System Integrator for Supply, Installation, Integration, Testing, Commissioning and Operation & Maintenance of Electronic Toll Collection (ETC) System including Medium Speed Weigh -in-Motion (MSWIM) and Static Weigh Bridge (SWB) System at toll plaza mentioned below: a) Near Arwal-Sahar bridge towards Arwal in the State of Bihar. b) On SH-81 at Medinipur near Nargang in the State of Bihar. c) On SH 81 at Gopalgur near Chandl in the State of Bihar. d) On SH 102 near Piro in the State of Bihar. e) On Ara Chapra bridge towards Ara side in the state of Bihar.	18.27	28.27	₹10,000/- (Non-Refundable)	₹11800/- (Eleven Thousand Eight Hundred) only	02 Months + 3 Years Maintenance

Schedule:-

1	Downloading of Bid Documents	From 01/10/2026 (10:00 Hrs.) to 15/10/2026 (15:00 Hrs.) (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
2	Pre-Bid Meeting	06.10.2026 at 15:00 Hrs. (Venue:-Meeting Hall of BRPNL, 7, Sardar Patel Marg, Patna-800015)
3	Last Date/Time of submission/uploading of offer Bid	15.10.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.
4	Date & Time for opening of Technical Bid	15/10/2026 upto 15:30 Hrs. (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
5	Date, Time and Place of opening of Financial Bid	To be notified after Technical Bid Evaluation on website: (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
6	Validity of Bid	180 days

The Eligibility Criteria, detailed scope of work etc. can be download from website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in and www.brpnnl.bihar.gov.in may kindly be referred.
For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

Senior Project Engineer
Bihar Rajya Pul Nirman Nigam Limited
Works Division, Ara

PR- 012531 (B & C) 2026-27



Govt. of Bihar

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार , दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।



बिहार राज्य पुल निर्माण निगम लिमिटेड
(बिहार सरकार का एक प्रविधान)
वरीय परियोजना अभियंता का कार्यालय
कार्य प्रमंडल कटिहार।

वेबसाइट: <http://www.brpnnl.bihar.in> ई-मेल: spe-katihar@brpnn.co.in

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(केवल ई-टेंडर पद्धति के अनुसार वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)

NIT No.& BRPNL/KTR/ C011/1411

बिहार राज्य पुल निर्माण निगम लिमिटेड/ केन्द्रीय/राज्य सरकार/एम&ईएस&सी/सी&पी&डी/सर्वजनिक क्षेत्र के समुचित अंगी में निबंधित संवेद्यकों से SBD आधारित ई-निविदा प्रक्रिया के माध्यम से दो बीड प्रणाली (एक-नौकी एवं वीडियो) अन्तर्गत निम्नलिखित टोल प्लाजा निर्माण कार्य हेतु मदवार दर (Item Rate) प्रस्ताव आमंत्रित किये जाते हैं। यदि संवेद्यक बिहार राज्य पुल निर्माण निगम लिमिटेड में पूर्व से निबंधित नहीं है, तब एकराजामा के पूर्व इन्हें निगम में निबंधित कराना अनिवार्य होगा।

क्र.सं०	जिला	कार्य का विवरण	प्राकलित राशि (लाख रु० में)	परिमाणु राशि (Online Payment) (रु० में)	अग्रयन की राशि (लाख रु० में)	Bid Processing Fee (Online Payment) (रु० में)	कार्य की अवधि (माह में)
1	कटिहार	Construction of (2+1) x 2 lane Toll Plaza including administration and other allied civil works near Jhaui bridge (SH-98) towards Salmari including installation, operation & maintenance of Electronic toll collection system software & hardware as well as maintenance of civil work in the State of Bihar.	833.67	10000	16.68	11800	6
2	पूर्णियाँ	Construction of (2+1) x 2 lane Toll Plaza including administration and other allied civil works near Baisa bridge (SH-99) towards Shishabari including installation, operation & maintenance of Electronic toll collection system software & hardware as well as maintenance of civil work in the State of Bihar.	1162.42	10000	21.63	11800	6

Schedule :-

Sl. No.	Activity	Duration
1.	Download/Upload date of bid documents	From 01.10.2026 (10.00 Hrs.) to 10.10.2026 (upto 15.00 HRS) [www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in]
2.	Pre-bid Meeting	03.10.2026, 15:00 HRS Venue :- Conference Hall, BRPNL, 7, Sardar Patel Marg, Patna-800015
3.	Last Date/Time for submission/uploading of offer/Bid	10.10.2026 upto 15:00 Hrs (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
4.	Submission of Bank Guarantee/EMD in original (in Hard Copy)	10.10.2026 upto 15:30 Hrs Venue :- Dy. CE Work Circle-02, BRPNL, 7, Sardar Patel Marg, Patna-800015/Senior project Engineer Works Division Katihar, Mirchaibari, 854105
5.	Date and time for Opening of Technical Bid	12.10.2026 upto 16:00 Hrs (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
6.	Date, time and place of opening of Financial Bid	To be informed later to technically qualified bidder. (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

7. अनुमानित/प्राकलित राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है तथा कार्य स्थल के अनुसार निरूपण में परिवर्तन किया जा सकता है।

8. किसी भी प्रकार की जानकारी अथवा शुद्धि पत्र को वेबसाइट <http://brpnnl.bihar.gov.in> एवं www.eproc2.gov.in पर प्रकाशित किया जायेगा।

9. निविदा की वैध अवधि :- बीड समाप्त की अंतिम तिथि से 180 दिन तक। वैध अवधि समाप्त होने की स्थिति में निविदाकारों से निविदा की वैध अवधि बढ़ाये जाने की सहमति ली जा सकती है।

10. Coordination with System Integration contractor : System integration work will be executed by a separate System Integrator contractor engaged by the Authority. The civil contractor shall execute its scope of work in parallel with, and in close coordination with, the system Integrator contractor and the Engineer-in-Charge, so that installation, testing, commissioning, Site Acceptance Test (SAT) and Go-Live of the ETC, MSWIM and SWB System are completed within the prescribed milestones.

सम्पर्क प्रशासिकारी का नाम :-

- वरीय परियोजना अभियंता, मो०न०-8544402464
- परियोजना अभियंता, मो०न०-9153962622

उक्त सूचना www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर भी देखी जा सकती है।

PR. No. 012431 (B&C) 2026-27 वरीय परियोजना अभियंता

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

बिहार राज्य पुल निर्माण निगम लि०,
कार्य प्रमंडल, कटिहार



North Eastern Railway
E-Tendering Tender Notice
Divisional Engineer/Mechanical Workshop for Chief Workshop Manager, N.E. Railway, Mechanical Workshop, Gorakhpur for and on behalf of President of India invites open tender through on line (E-Tendering) for the following work. **S. No. 1 E-Tender Notice No & Name of the work : DEN-MWS-2026-09** GKPS-Development of Centre of Excellence for Wheel Shop in Mechanical Workshop/Gorakhpur (as per Drawing no. G/LT-1107 Alt-1)
Estimated cost (Rs.): 1.04,37,031.71
Earnest Money (Rs.): 2.08,800.00
Tender submission last date & Time : 27.10.2026 & 11.00 hrs. • The details of above tender is available on Indian Railway website www.irps.gov.in.
MWS
Gorakhpur
CPRO/Mech-89
DONOT SMOKE BIDI/CIGARETTE IN TRAINS



Govt. of Bihar

कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबंधक, यूनिट-17
कसदुखान एण्ड डिजाइन सर्विसेज
उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय)
(उपग्रो सार्वजनिक का उपक्रम)
कार्यालय: कृष्ण नगर मधुवा-281004
प्रधान कार्यालय: टी.सी. 38-सी, विद्युति खण्ड,
गोमलीनगर, लखनऊ-226010
Visit us at : www.cdsupjn.org
Email : pm17cds@gmail.com
फोन : 8800911902

L.No. 1024/M-14/229
Dated: 24.09.2026

ई-निविदा सूचना

उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम, की ओर से अधोस्तराधी द्वारा जनपद मधुवा की पुलिस लाइन परिसर में पानी की निकासी के लिये नाला, बाउण्ड्रीवाल (50 मी.) आदि के निर्माण कार्य अनुमानित लागत **₹ 160.99 लाख** (जी.एस.टी. रहित एवं लेवर सेस सहित) हेतु सी. एण्ड डी.एस. में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से दिनांक 26.10.2026 के अपराह्न 17:00 बजे तक ई-निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। उक्त कार्य हेतु ई-निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 25.09.2026 से दिनांक 26.10.2026 के मध्य उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार की e-procurement वेबसाइट <https://etender.up.nic.in> से डाउनलोड किये जा सकते हैं तथा ई-निविदा दिनांक 27.10.2026 को 14:00 बजे परियोजना प्रबंधक, यूनिट-17, सी. एण्ड डी. एस., उ.प्र. जल निगम (नगरीय), मधुवा में खोली जायेगी। ई-निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य **₹ 10,000.00 + GST (18%)** कुल **₹ 11,800.00** देय होगा।

निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत विवरण विभाग की वेबसाइट www.cdsupjn.org एवं प्रोक्तोरेट पोर्टल <https://etender.up.nic.in> पर उपलब्ध है। समस्त शुद्धि पत्र (Corrigendum) <https://etender.up.nic.in> पर ही अपलोड किये जायेंगे, इन्का प्रत्येक से कोई प्रकाशन नहीं किया जायेगा। निविदादाताओं को सलाह दी जाती है कि वे उक्त वेबसाइट का समय-समय पर अवलोकन करते रहें।



Govt. of Bihar

**OFFICE OF SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
CONSTRUCTION CIRCLE,
U.P. JAL NIGAM (URBAN)**
R-1, Sector-1 In Front of New Railway Station, Rajnagar, Ghaziabad - 201002 (U.P.)
E-Mail: se18upjn@yahoo.co.in

Letter No.: 2045/SBM (U)-GZB-NP-Faridnagar&8D works/09
Dated: 24.09.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) invites E-bids for execution of "Investigation, Survey (On G.I.S. Basis) & Construction of Interception & Diversion works with treatment facilities alongwith treated effluent line etc. in Various zone of, in Faridnagar Nagar Panchayat, Distt- Ghaziabad under SBM-(U)-2.0 Programme". Bids are invited in two bid system on percentage basis from eligible, reputed and experienced bidders.

E-tender document will be available for download from dated 26.09.2026 from 05:00 PM. Pre-bid meeting will be held on dated 03.10.2026 at 03:00 PM in the office of undersigned. E-bids can be submitted till 12.10.2026 up to 05:00 PM and technical bid shall be opened on 13.10.2026 at 3:30 PM in the office of Superintending Engineer, Construction Circle, U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban), Ghaziabad in presence of contractors or their authorized representatives. E-tender Cost is Rs. 10,000.00+ GST @ 18% for tender. The tender document & details are available on U.P. Govt. e-procurement portal <http://etender.up.nic.in> & U.P.J.N. (Urban) website www.jn.upscd.gov.in.



Govt. of Bihar

**OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER MECHANICAL
DIVISION BHEP, CHANDERKOTE**
GIST OF e-TENDER NOTICE

For and on behalf of Managing Director JKPCDC, e-tenders are invited from reputed Firms/ Contractors having relevant experience for the below mentioned work:

S. No	Name of Work	e-NITNo.& Date	Due Date	Tenders receiving Authority
1.	SITC of new booster pump 02 no along with motors and valves and accessories and GI pipeline from ventilation tunnel to collection gallery approximate length 400 mtrs at BHEP-II.	18-AMECH of 2026-27 Dated 24-09-2026	15-10-2026 at 16:00 Hrs	Executive Engineer, Mechanical Division, BHEP, Chanderkote

For details of work, terms and conditions and any other clarifications, kindly visit www.iktenders.gov.in, you can also contact the Office of the undersigned on any working day up to 15.10.2026 till 14:00 Hrs.

Executive Engineer,
Mechanical Division,
BHEP, Chanderkote.

DIP/J-2346-P/26



Govt. of Bihar

Govt. of Bihar
Patna Smart City Limited (PSC)
NOTICE INVITING RE-TENDER FOR

Selection Of Concessionaire For Operation, Maintenance, Commercial Management & Revenue Enhancement Of The Newly Developed Facility, The "Common Service Building" Near Mithapur Metro Station, Patna Under Patna Smart City Limited.

(Through e-procurement mode only- www.eproc2bihar.gov.in)

NIT No. – 20/MD/PSC/2026-27

Patna Smart City Limited (PSC) invites bids from eligible experienced Firms/ /Contractors / Agencies / Bidders registered in appropriate category in any Government Organization/PSUs for execution of works as given below:-

Name of Work	Bid Document (Non-Refundable)	Bid Security (EMD)	Bid Processing Fee
Selection Of Concessionaire For Operation, Maintenance, Commercial Management & Revenue Enhancement Of The Newly Developed Facility, The "Common Service Building" Near Mithapur Metro Station, Patna Under Patna Smart City Limited.	Rs. 11,800/-	As per RFP	As per Eproc2 website
2. Date of Downloading of Bid Document	From 21.09.2026 to 12 .10.2026 upto 1500 hours. Through website : www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in		
3. Place & Date of pre-bid meeting	Date: 30.09.2026, Time 1300 hours; Patna Smart City Limited, 4th Floor, ICC - cum- PSC Building, SSP Office Campus, Gandhi Maidan, Patna-800001		
4. Last date of Receiving Queries (Online)	Date: 30.09.2026, Time 1700 hours (through e-mail)		
5. Last Date and time for uploading of bid.	Date: 30.09.2026 up to 1500 hours through website - www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in		
6. Time & Date of opening technical bids	Date: 12.10.2026, Time 1000 hours		
7. Time & date of opening financial bids	To be communicated later on		
8. Place of opening of Bid	Through website : www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in		
9. Periods of bids validity	120 Days.		
10. Officer inviting bids	Managing Director, PSC, Patna.		
11. For participation in E-tendering proc. the contractor shall have to get themselves registered to get User ID, Password & digital signature. This will enable accessing the website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in & download/ participate in E-tender.			
12. The tender documents can be obtained through our website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in & http://www.smartpatna.co.in .			
16. The authority shall have the right to reject the bid without assigning any reason what so ever. For any information department Contact No. 06122219180 may be used.			
17. For queries & Clarifications, if any, send e-mail to patnasmartcity.psc@gmail.com .			

For further details please visit website state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

PR- 012537 (B & C) 2026-27 Managing Director
Patna Smart City Limited

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।



Govt. of Bihar

BENGALURU EAST CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Senior Assistant Director of Horticulture, Mahadevapura / K.R. Pura Zone, Vengaihan Lake ECO Park, K.R. Pura, Bengaluru-560036.

No: SADH(S)TENDER/201/2026-27 Date: 25-09-2026

INVITATION FOR TENDER (IFT) - (SHORT TERM)
(Two Cover System) (Through GOK KPP Portal only)

The Senior Assistant Director of Horticulture (Mahadevapura / K.R. Pura Zone), BECC, Bengaluru (Referred to as Employer in these documents) invites Tenders to Implement Works in accordance with KTPP Rules 2000, from eligible and experienced Person / Agencies / Firms (Referred to as Tenderers in these documents) registered in Labour Department for Development of Parks.

(Standard Tender Document - KW-3)

Sl. No.	Name of the Work
1	Beautification and Landscape Development, with Borewell Drilling and Other Civil Works in A. Narayanapura Bande Park (West Side) in Ward No. 20, K.R. Pura Constituency. Amount Put to Tender (Excluding GST) (in Rs.): 1,50,00,000/-, EMD Amount (in Rs.): 2,25,000/-

Calendar of Events: 1) Tender documents can be downloaded from the GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Website: <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> from 28-09-2026. 2) Last Date for Queries: 03-10-2026. 3) Date of Pre Bid Meeting: 03-10-2026. 4) Date of Tender Closing: 06-10-2026. 5) Date of Opening of Technical Bid: 08-10-2026. 6) Date of Opening of Financial Bid: After Approval of Technical Bid. Further details can be had from the above office.

Sd/- Senior Assistant Director of Horticulture
Mahadevapura / K.R. Pura Zone, BECC.



Govt. of Bihar

BENGALURU SMART INFRASTRUCTURE LIMITED (B-SMILE)
Office of the Project Engineer-02,
No. 30/1, Thimmaiah Road, Miller Tank Bund Area, Vasanth Nagar, Bengaluru-560051

No: B-SMILE/PE-02/TEND/04/2026-27/CORRIGENDUM-2 Date: 25.09.2026

CORRIGENDUM-2
(Addendum issued under Clause 2.9 of the RFP)

Ref: 1. Notice Inviting Tender No. B-SMILE/PE-02/TEND/04/2026-27 dated 17.08.2026.
2. Request for Proposal (RFP) for the Project- Clause 1.3 (Schedule of Bidding Process), Clause 2.9 (Amendment of RFP) and Clause 6.2(b).
3. Corrigendum-1 No. B-SMILE/PE-02/TEND/04/2026-27/CORRIGENDUM-1 dated 08.09.2026.
4. As per Approval of Competent Authority Vide no. e-278639 Dated: 24.09.2026.

Sub: Construction of Elevated Corridor from Marenahalli Main Road (Ragigudda junction) to Kanakapura Main Road via BWSSB Pipeline Road (Thalaghattapura junction) in Bengaluru City on BOOT (Toll) Mode - Dynamic Duration - Extension of the date for the Authority's response to pre-bid queries and of the Bid Due Date- Corrigendum-2- reg.

In exercise of the powers reserved to the Authority under Clause 2.9 (Amendment of RFP) read with Clause 6.2(b) of the RFP, and in order to afford prospective Bidders reasonable time to take into account the Authority's responses to the pre-bid queries and the revised Bidding Documents issued therewith, and to encourage wider participation in the Bidding Process, the Schedule of Bidding Process at Clause 1.3 of the RFP as revised by Corrigendum-1 dated 08.09.2026, and the corresponding Calendar of Events notified in the Notice Inviting Tender under reference, are hereby further revised as under:

Sl. No.	Event Description	Existing Date / Time	Revised Date / Time
1	Invitation of RFP (NIT)	17.08.2026 @ 4:00 p.m.	No change
2	Date and time for availability of tender documents in KPP Portal	20.08.2026 @ 4:00 p.m.	No change
3	Last date for submission of pre-bid queries	01.09.2026 upto 4:30 p.m.	No change
4	Date and time of pre-bid meeting	02.09.2026, 3:00 p.m. @ B-SMILE HQ	No change (meeing held)
5	Authority response to pre-bid queries latest by	11.09.2026 upto 4:00 p.m.	05.10.2026 upto 4:00 p.m.
6	Bid due date (Last date & time for receipt of tenders)	14.10.2026 upto 4:30 p.m.	05.11.2026 upto 4:30 p.m.
7	Physical submission of bid security / power of attorney etc.	14.10.2026 upto 4:30 p.m.	05.11.2026 upto 4:30 p.m.
8	Date & time of opening of technical bid	15.10.2026	06.11.2026
9	Declaration of eligible / qualified bidders	16.11.2026	30.11.2026
10	Opening of Financial bid	Will be notified	Will be notified
11	Letter of Award (LOA)	15.12.2026	Will be notified
12	Validity of bid	180 days from bid due date	180 days from the revised bid due date, i.e. up to and including 04.05.2027
13	Signing of Concession Agreement	Within 45 days of award of LOA	No change

This Corrigendum is published on the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal (<https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>) in terms of the Notice Inviting Tender.

Sd/-
Project Engineer-2
Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited (B-SMILE)



Govt. of Bihar

**GOVERNMENT OF JAMMU AND KASHMIR
DIRECTORATE OF HORTICULTURE, KASHMIR**
Rajbagh-Srinagar opposite Presentation Convent School -190008
TELE-FAX: 01943100919 website: <http://hortikashmir.gov.in>
Email: dhk-Kashmir@jk.gov.in
Extension of Tender Notices of :

1. e-NIT No.81 of 2026 (Tender ID:2026_HPD_322990_1),
2. e-NIT No.82 of 2026 (Tender ID:2026_HPD_323039_1),
3. e-NIT No.83 of 2026 (Tender ID:2026_HPD_323071_1),

Subject: Extension of Tender Submission Date - Import of Rootstock of Different Fruit Crops, thereof:

It is hereby notified for information of all concerned that the e-NIT No.81 of 2026 (Tender ID:2026_HPD_322990_1) dated 01-09-2026 (Pear), e-NIT No.82 of 2026 (Tender ID:2026_HPD_323039_1) dated 01-09-2026-2026 (Cherry) and e-NIT No.83 of 2026 (Tender ID:2026_HPD_323071_1) dated 01-09-2026 (Almond), issued by this Directorate for the "Import of Rootstock of Different Fruit Crops" is hereby extended by further period of 15 (fifteen) days from the date of publication of this notice.

• Last Date of Submission: - 07-10-2026
• Opening Date for Tender: -10-10-2026

(All other terms and conditions of the said tender shall remain unchanged).

The prospective bidders are advised to visit the JK Tenders Portal <https://jktenders.gov.in> regularly for updated details, dates, and any further information.

Sd/-
(Vikas Anand)
DIRECTOR

DIPK-6065/26



Govt. of Bihar

**Directorate Farmer Welfare & Agriculture Development
Madhya Pradesh, Bhopal
Vindhyanchal Bhawan, Arera Hills, Bhopal**

No./IT/RKVY New Project/DPGI&DPG/e-Vikas/2026-27/1031

Bhopal, dated 22.09.2026

Tender Notice

The Department of Farmer Welfare and Agriculture Development, Government of Madhya Pradesh invites proposals for Enhancement, Operation, Maintenance and Technical Support along with Helpline of e-Vikas Pranali (Vitrn Evam Krishi Apoori Samadhan) through e-procurement portal (<https://mptenders.gov.in>). No physical submission of the bids shall be entertained.

Schedule of Bid Process:-

Date of issue of RFP document	23/09/2026 at 5.00 PM
Pre-Bid Queries	Bidders should submit the queries in prescribed format through e-mail at: dagit@mp.gov.in , diragri@mp.gov.in On or before 5.00 PM 01/10/2026 5.00 PM
Date of Pre-Bid Meeting	05/10/2026 at 4.30 PM
Start Date for Submission of Proposals	25/09/2026 at 5.00 PM
Last Date for Submission of Proposals	16/10/2026 at 5.00 PM
Date of Opening of PQ cum Technical Bid	19/10/2026 at 3.00 PM

For any clarification, kindly contact
Email: dagit@mp.gov.in
Phone: 0755-2551336

Director
Farmer Welfare and Agriculture Development
M.P., Bhopal

G19077/26



Govt. of Bihar

Jammu & Kashmir Bank Limited
Cross Selling Department,
Corporate Headquarters, M. A. Road
Srinagar, 190 001 J&K

Online Request for Proposal (e-RFP) FOR GROUP ACCIDENTAL INSURANCE COVER TO PERMANENT EMPLOYEES OF UT GOVERNMENT OF J&K & Ladakh including CORPORATIONS/ PSUs/AUTONOMOUS BODIES/LOCAL BODIES/UNIVERSITIES, SHRI MATA VAISHNO DEVI SHRINE BOARD (SMVDSB), POLICE/ SPOs

RFP Notice along with Complete RFP document outlining the minimum requirements can be downloaded from and BIDs can be submitted on the Banks' e-Tendering Portal <https://jkbank.abcpocure.com> w.e.f. September 25, 2026 16.00 Hrs. Tender Document can also be downloaded from Bank's Official Website <https://jkbank.in/tenderNotice>. Last date for submission of Bids is October 09, 2026, 17.00 Hrs. e-RFP Ref. No JKB/E&ED/GAI-EMP-UT/2026-1908 Dated : 24-09-2026

Registered Office : Corporate Headquarters, M.A.Road, Srinagar 190001, Kashmir, India
CIN: L65102JK19385G000048 ; T : +91 (0)194 2481 930-35 ; F : +91 (0)194 248 1928; E : info@jkbmail.com ; W : <https://jkb.bank.in>



Govt. of Bihar

ODISHA CONSTRUCTION CORPORATION LIMITED
BHUBANESWAR, ODISHA, PIN:751012, Tel No.(0674) 2562020,
e-Mail : theooccltd@odishaconstruction.com
GSTIN - 21AAAC02571K2ZM

"e"-Procurement Notice No. 15 /OCCL/2026-27 (on-line)

On-line percentage rate tender is invited for the following work :

Sl No.	Name of Work	Bid Identification No.	Approx. Value of work (Rs. in Lakhs)	Bid Security (through on-line transfer / as per DTCN) (in Rs.)	Period of Completion	Availability of Tender (on-line)
01	Integrated Development of Hirakud Reservoir & its surroundings- Dam Museum- Interiors & Fit-Out	OCCL-SMP/01/2026-27	Rs.1999.61 Lakhs	Rs.20,00,000/-	06 (Six) Calendar months	From 29.09.2026, 3.30 PM to 21.10.2026, 5.30 PM.

Procurement Officer : Managing Director, OCCL
Date of Opening of the Technical Bid : 22.10.2026, 12.00 Noon onwards.
Further details can be seen from the e-procurement portal : <https://www.tendersodisha.gov.in>

34001/880/2627

MANAGING DIRECTOR
OIPR-34001/34120/1/26-27/0016



Govt. of Bihar

SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE FOR MISCELLANEOUS CONSTRUCTION WORKS

Tender Notice No. Sr. DEE (RS&G) BSP/OTP/26-27-14. Dtd. 18.09.2026
Name of Work: "Construction of 20 unit Type-II, 6 unit Type-III, 10 unit Type-IV Quarters, Service buildings, ADEN, ADEE, DSTE & ARM offices and Officers Rest House, Overhead Tank, Pump House, RPF Barrack and other miscellaneous work" at Baikunthpur Road (BRH)."
Tender Value (Approx.) : ₹ 1,34,52,498/-, EMD Amount : ₹ 2,69,100/-, Tender Closing Date & Time : 16/10/2026, Time 15:00 Hrs.
For further details, eligibility criteria & the complete details for the above work, please refer/download tender document which is available on website: www.irps.gov.in.
Sr. Divl. Elect. Engineer (RS&G) CPR/10/422 S.E.C. Railway, Bilaspur.



Overweight and weak
The UN is unwieldy, and needs to move
away from superpower hegemony

The 81st session of the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) could have been written off as just another year, with another set of speeches delivered on the global multilateral stage. However, this year, the UN’s annual Summit has a unique sense of urgency. This is UN Secretary-General (UNSG) António Guterres’s final session, after a tenure marked by a record number of global crises, conflicts, pandemics, climate disasters and the advent of a dangerous age of Artificial Intelligence. Not since the Second World War have there been so many conflicts; one study recorded more than 65 conflicts across 35 countries in 2025, the highest since 1946. Growing polarisation on every major issue, wars by global superpowers in violation of the UN charter, nuclear threats and the imposition of unilateral and illegitimate sanctions have weakened the UN, which at 81 seems overweight, weak and unrepresentative of the world. This makes it an important year for the world to unite in favour of a strengthened and reformed UN while choosing the next UNSG to guide that process over the next decade. This is an important year for South Asia too, with the election of Bangladesh’s Foreign Minister Khalilur Rahman as the President of the UNGA’s 81st session; he will oversee the UNSG’s selection. It was disappointing that the world’s most powerful leaders and those at the heart of the conflicts in Ukraine, Gaza and the Persian Gulf failed to suggest solutions for the future. U.S. President Donald Trump spoke about the possible “annihilation” of Iran, and defended U.S. actions in Venezuela. Much to India’s chagrin, he again claimed to have negotiated peace in conflicts including the 2025 India-Pakistan four-day war. Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian referred to the U.S. and Israel as “murderers, terrorists and assassins”. The Russian President skipped the session, while the U.S. denied visas to the Palestinian delegation. An initiative led by the European Union and a few other countries, co-sponsored by India, to build a Partnership for Multilateralism (P4M) beyond superpower hegemony is well-meaning, but was drowned out by the rancour at this year’s UNGA. For India, this year was significant as the Narendra Modi government launched a campaign for a second two-year non-permanent term in the UN Security Council in 2028-29. It was therefore surprising that Mr. Modi decided to skip the UNGA speech this year, and the multilateral summits on the side-lines, fresh from his hosting of the Delhi BRICS Summit. India’s voice, of a balancing power that speaks for a rules-based international order based on the UN Charter, diplomacy and dialogue, is needed more than ever amidst the global warmongering.

Narrowed posture
Karnataka must not reject the full
framework of eco-sensitive areas

The Kasturirangan Report bears a pro-development attitude that allows human occupation and a range of economic activity across the Western Ghats, yet the Karnataka Assembly unanimously repudiated its recommendations. A grievance concerned the accuracy of the remote-sensing and satellite data from 2012 that the Report uses to distinguish natural from human-dominated landscapes. Another concern was its recommendation that an entire revenue village be placed within an ‘ecologically sensitive area’ (ESA) if at least 20% of its area is sensitive. This could bring farmland and human settlements within the ESA even when sensitive areas occupy only a fraction of the village. Following the Centre’s directive to States in 2013-14 to begin ground-truthing the Report’s recommendations, Karnataka faced bipartisan opposition centered on concerns about livelihoods, with vested interests, including stakeholders of activities both the Gadgil and the Kasturirangan Reports restrict/ban such as mining, allegedly fanning fears of displacement. The State thus elected to resist the ESA framework. Although the Assembly’s resolution proposes returning to the unfinished task of producing an alternative map, the government’s posture also faces a wider challenge. The Centre’s interim directions in 2013 preserve some protection for the ecosystems that the State stewards, but for the government and the businesses within potential ESAs, the delay may prolong uncertainty over what forms of planned development will ultimately be permitted. Broadly, particular States confront the economic and political consequences of local resistance and foregone development while the country as a whole will capture much of the national benefit of conserving the Ghats, so States have an incentive to negotiate the ESAs’ extent down. However, as of mid-2026, Gujarat was reportedly close to an agreement with the Centre, Tamil Nadu had no substantive disagreement, Kerala wanted to reduce its already ground-truthed 9,993 sq. km to 8,805 sq. km, and Maharashtra and Goa wanted 378 and 21 villages omitted, respectively. These instances of progress (such as they are), the Ghats’ continuity across six States, and the Centre’s 2024 decision to allow ESAs in the region to be notified State by State increase pressure on Karnataka without legally binding it to its neighbours’ choices. Specifically, Karnataka’s ability to continue rejecting the framework as a whole becomes harder to sustain if it does not also produce an equally considered alternative. Karnataka needs to reconcile the apprehensions of its farmers and workers with the responsibilities accruing to the State with the largest share (by area) of the proposed ESAs.

The case for accountable lottery regulation in India

Urged to ban tobacco, Napoleon III, Emperor of France (1852-70), replied, “This vice brings in one hundred million francs in taxes every year. I will certainly forbid it at once – as soon as you can name a virtue that brings in as much revenue.” His uncle, Napoleon Bonaparte, is also credited with calling vices “very good patriots” (though the attribution is uncertain), while Ralph Waldo Emerson observed that “tobacco could cheerfully carry the load of armies”. Different voices, one hard-headed insight: vices are fiscally invaluable. Yet, every age has moral crusaders whose puritanical zeal to ban tobacco, alcohol, or lotteries rests on the misconception – and conceit – that the state can extinguish persistent demand simply by declaring an activity unlawful. Pragmatists know better: a prohibition may be morally appealing yet administratively futile – or, worse, positively counterproductive. The United States learnt this lesson the hard way. Following a sustained temperance campaign, it imposed prohibition through the Eighteenth Amendment and the Volstead Act, from 1920 to 1933. While suppressing legal supply, prohibition left demand intact, fuelling a lucrative black market controlled by violent syndicates such as Al Capone’s. Bootlegging corrupted public institutions, deprived governments of excise revenue and imposed heavy enforcement costs. The Twenty-First Amendment repealed prohibition, recognising that a regulated and taxed market could cause fewer harms than an unenforceable ban. States in India that have experimented with prohibition have faced similar challenges.

The argument for regulation
Lotteries are undoubtedly a vice, though arguably less pernicious than tobacco or alcohol. They disproportionately burden poorer households, encouraging them to stake scarce income on remote chances of reward. Rapid draws and instant games can encourage compulsive play and loss-chasing, while giant jackpots distort risk perception. Credit sales, opaque odds and manipulative advertising compound these harms. These are powerful arguments for stringent regulation, not necessarily prohibition. Lottery bans can push players towards smuggled tickets, *matka*, *satta*, single-digit rackets and offshore portals. Operating through cash agents and mule accounts, these enterprises lack audits and age restrictions, secure prize funds and effective remedies against fraud. Governments lose lottery surpluses and GST revenue, while legitimate vendors, many of them poor or disabled, lose livelihoods and enforcement costs rise. In seeking to protect the vulnerable, the state may instead leave them at the mercy of unaccountable operators.



K. Ashok Vardhan Shetty
Retired IAS officer, a former Vice-Chancellor of the Indian Maritime University, Chennai, and Member, The Justice Kurian Joseph Committee on Union-State Relations

Regulation, not prohibition, can curb lottery harms while preserving accountability

The state’s paternalism is not class-neutral. Affluent citizens can day-trade, use leveraged derivatives or speculate in crypto-assets despite the risk of ruinous losses. Securities trading involves skill and derivatives facilitate hedging and price discovery. Yet, the state does not test competence before admitting retail traders to these markets. The Securities and Exchange Board of India found that the vast majority of day traders and futures-and-options traders incurred losses. Financial markets are legal not because everyone acts wisely, but because risks are disclosed, intermediaries regulated and fraud punished, while adult choice is preserved. Lotteries can follow the same principle, with more stringent safeguards appropriate to games of chance.

The international norm
Lotteries are legal in nearly four-fifths of countries. Blanket prohibition survives mainly in countries enforcing strict Sharia-based gambling prohibitions, such as Saudi Arabia, Iran and Brunei, and in closed ideological regimes such as Cuba. Across diverse political and economic systems, the norm is controlled legality, with lottery surpluses allocated transparently to education, health care, sports, welfare or infrastructure. Nearly 70% of lottery jurisdictions follow the public-operator model, in which a government body, statutory authority or State-owned company runs the lottery while private firms provide retail and technology services. Under the concession model, the State regulates the lottery but grants operating rights to a private concessionaire. Federal countries generally entrust lotteries to their constituent units while permitting voluntary cooperation across borders. Lotteries operate in 45 of the 50 U.S. States and Washington DC; all 10 Canadian provinces and three territories; all six Australian States and both mainland territories; and all 16 German Länder. Authorisation in one jurisdiction does not confer the right to sell in another. Cross-border sales require the destination jurisdiction’s consent or participation in a cooperative arrangement. The U.S.’s Powerball, Canada’s Lotto 6/49, Australian lottery blocs and Germany’s DLTB allow participating jurisdictions to pool players and prizes while retaining regulatory autonomy. A Lok Sabha reply of March 14, 2023, identified only nine States operating lotteries: Arunachal Pradesh, Goa, Keralam, Maharashtra, Mizoram, Nagaland, Punjab, Sikkim and West Bengal. Amid persistent State fiscal stress, the widespread preference for prohibition deserves reconsideration. Government-organised lotteries fall under Entry 40 of the Union List. The Lotteries (Regulation) Act, 1998, permits States to organise lotteries subject to Section 4 conditions,

while Sections 5 and 6 empower States and the Union Government, respectively, to prohibit lotteries that violate Sections 4 and 5. **Two necessary amendments** Settled Supreme Court jurisprudence treats gambling, including State-organised lotteries, as *res extra commercium*, outside the protections of Articles 19(1)(g) – fundamental right to trade – and 301 – freedom of trade across India. Section 5 of the Lotteries (Regulation) Act, 1998, reflects this principle by allowing States to prohibit outside lotteries. A parallel doctrine applies to potable alcohol, allowing States to restrict or prohibit out-of-State consignments. Yet, in *B.R. Enterprises vs State of U.P.* (1999), the Court read Section 5 down: a State may exclude other States’ lotteries only by abandoning its own and becoming wholly lottery-free. This all-or-nothing rule is difficult to justify. While a State directly oversees its own lottery administration, its oversight of another State’s operations within its territory is necessarily indirect, even as it bears the local enforcement burden. This disparity in regulatory control underpins the case for excluding other States’ lotteries. Faced with this revenue-regulation trade-off, Tamil Nadu (2003) and Karnataka (2007) chose total prohibition, thereby forfeiting the option of running accountable public lotteries of their own. Parliament should amend Section 5 to clarify that the provision applies “whether or not the prohibiting State organises a lottery of its own”. Destination-State consent should be decisive, subject to uniform treatment: a State must either admit all outside lotteries or exclude them all. Smaller States, especially in the northeast, may fear exclusion from larger markets, but compulsory access is no remedy. A new Section 4A should authorise two or more States to establish a common lottery by agreement, pooling players, prizes, technology and costs, as in successful multi-State lotteries elsewhere. Transparent regulation offers a more accountable alternative to prohibition. Section 4 permits States to sell tickets directly or through distributors or agents. While marketing agents may provide guaranteed revenue, departmental operation can be more transparent and enable retail distribution through small vendors, persons with disabilities, women’s self-help groups and cooperatives, broadening livelihood opportunities and limiting intermediary capture. Kerala follows this model. In FY 2023-24, it earned ₹2,883.80 crore – ₹1,129.71 crore in net lottery revenue (or surplus) and ₹1,754.09 crore in State GST. It channels lottery surpluses into health care and welfare. Kerala’s public-operator model offers a useful, though not exclusive, template for reform.

Revisiting India’s nuclear doctrine without revising it

India’s nuclear doctrine has remained largely unchanged for over two decades, even as its security environment has shifted dramatically. Since its operationalisation in 2003, China’s military rise has accelerated, Pakistan’s nuclear posture has evolved, disruptive technologies have reshaped deterrence, and geopolitical competition has become more multipolar. Yet, the doctrine’s core principles – credible minimum deterrence and a declared No First Use (NFU) posture – have endured, albeit with a specific provision retaining the option of nuclear retaliation following a major biological or chemical attack on India or Indian forces. The question is whether a framework crafted for the early 2000s remains fully aligned with the security challenges of the mid-2020s.

A doctrine for another era, strategic shifts
India’s nuclear doctrine emerged from the distinct strategic context of the late 1990s. The 1998 Pokhran-II tests established India as a nuclear weapons state, while Kargil (1999) showed that nuclear deterrence did not rule out conventional war. The 1999 Draft Nuclear Doctrine and the Cabinet Committee on Security’s January 4, 2003 decision sought to reconcile deterrence with restraint. The 2003 decision operationalised a posture based on credible minimum deterrence, No First Use (NFU) and massive retaliation to a nuclear attack, supported by a survivable second-strike capability and firm civilian control. Judged by its original objectives, the doctrine has provided continuity, predictability and strategic stability for more than two decades. The question is whether the assumptions underpinning it remain stable. The strategic environment underpinning the framework has changed in three important ways. First, China and Pakistan have grown more strategically aligned. When the doctrine was



Advitya Madan
Analyst on geopolitics, international and defence affairs, commanded 15 Punjab in Lebanon under the United Nations Flag, commanded 27 Sector as DIG in Churachandpur, Manipur, and was Brigadier Operational Logistics in HQ Western Command

India’s nuclear doctrine faces new strategic, technological and geopolitical challenges

formulated, the two nuclear-armed neighbours posed distinct challenges; today, those challenges are increasingly interconnected. China has expanded and modernised its nuclear forces, strengthened military infrastructure along the Line of Actual Control and deepened defence cooperation with Pakistan. Pakistan has diversified its nuclear capabilities, including tactical nuclear weapons intended to offset India’s conventional advantage. India must therefore account for the possibility that pressures from two closely aligned nuclear adversaries could interact during a crisis. The second shift is technological. Artificial intelligence, cyber capabilities, space-based surveillance, hypersonic weapons and ballistic missile defence are reshaping deterrence by shortening decision-making timelines, increasing the vulnerability of command-and-control networks and complicating assumptions about assured retaliation. These technologies do not invalidate the doctrine’s core principles, but they alter the environment in which they must operate. Nuclear deterrence ultimately depends on the alignment of doctrine, capability and survivability. The third shift is geopolitical. The Indo-Pacific has become a key arena of great-power competition, while the international system has grown more multipolar. U.S.-China rivalry, closer China-Russia coordination and India’s expanding partnerships have reshaped the security environment. Nuclear doctrine can no longer be viewed solely through bilateral deterrence; regional crises are increasingly shaped by wider geopolitical competition. **Review, not revision** Strategic doctrines are policy instruments, not immutable documents. In India’s case, a review could examine emerging technologies, command-and-control resilience, second-strike

capabilities and the continuing relevance of existing concepts, including the doctrine’s approach to retaliation. The issue of massive retaliation deserves scrutiny. Pakistan’s tactical nuclear weapons were intended to complicate India’s response options below the level of strategic exchange. A review could assess whether India’s declaratory posture provides sufficient deterrent clarity across nuclear contingencies, without necessarily changing its core principles. There are, however, reasons for caution. India’s doctrine has reinforced its image as a restrained and responsible nuclear power while providing continuity in deterrence. Ambiguity over established principles, particularly NFU, could create uncertainty, encourage adversaries to recalibrate and complicate crisis management. The priority, therefore, should be to strengthen operational capabilities, modernise delivery systems and improve command-and-control resilience rather than reopen declaratory policy. A review of NFU need not mean abandoning it. It could reaffirm its rationale, clarify its scope and ensure that supporting capabilities remain credible. Reviewing a doctrine is not the same as revising it. **Building credible capabilities** For India, any doctrinal review should also assess survivability, command and control, intelligence, early warning, cyber resilience and the nuclear triad. The aim should be to ensure that India’s declared policy remains backed by credible capabilities in a changing strategic environment, while aligning nuclear policy with its broader diplomatic objectives and strategic autonomy. Ultimately, a nuclear doctrine is an instrument of statecraft, not an immutable policy. India’s commitment to restraint, credible deterrence and responsible nuclear stewardship remains an enduring strategic asset.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Sanctity of public office
The desire to cling to office indefinitely, while disregarding transparency, accountability, the Constitution and the law, appears to have become the new norm in India. The values of humility, transparency and accountability in public life seem to have become things of the past, especially under the

government of the day. Its top leader may have many achievements to his name, but he has also encouraged an office-centric political culture within the BJP and among those joining it from other parties. The priority appears to be retaining office rather than upholding the sanctity of constitutional democracy. Leader of the Opposition (Lok Sabha) Rahul Gandhi

has urged Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar to resign (Page 1, September 25). Why should Mr. Kumar, when he has the backing of those at the top? The Election Commission of India’s constitutional responsibility is to ensure free and fair elections, and its decisions must command public confidence. The question is: why should constitutional

institutions not function in the letter and spirit of the Constitution and the law? Holding a constitutional office means little if its occupant does not uphold the values and the responsibilities attached to it. **P.K. Sharma,** Barnala, Punjab **Resignation demand** If the Chief Election

Commissioner of India quits, will all the deleted names be included in the Special Intensive Revision list? Conducting elections in a country such as India is a huge task because of its large population. In the last round of elections held in some States, the process was appreciated by many developed countries, whose representatives had said that the elections were

conducted in a free and fair manner. All appreciation goes to the Election Commission of India. Demanding the resignation of hardworking people with clean hands will only affect the country. **K.V. Sundaravelu,** Bengaluru Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the full postal address and the full name.

GROUND ZERO



Rajthal residents in Hansi, Haryana, keep round-the-clock vigil at the village entrance to prevent entry of drug peddlers. SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

The villages fighting back against drugs

The drug menace has spread from the borders of Haryana to the State's agricultural and semi-urban heartland, forcing khaps, gram panchayats, and community groups to step in where police action alone has failed to contain it. Communities are resorting to night patrols, fines, and direct action against peddlers. **Ashok Kumar** reports on these efforts and the widening gap in de-addiction and rehabilitation facilities

On the side of a busy road cutting through Rajthal village in Haryana's Hansi district, around 150 kilometres north-west of Delhi, stands a bright red-and-white banner tied to a yellow police barricade. In bold letters in Hindi, it reads, "*Nasha ke khilaf gram panchayat Rajthal ka sakht sandesh* (The strict message from the Rajthal gram panchayat (village council) against drug/substance abuse)." The warning below says: sell drugs in the village and pay ₹1 lakh; help a drug peddler get bail and pay another ₹1 lakh.

A few steps behind the barricade, men wearing white kurtas and turbans sit on red plastic chairs in a circle in the shade of a roadside tree. They are Rajthal's round-the-clock *thekri pehra* (community-led vigil). Their job is to guard their village and the entire stretch against drugs.

Satyawan Singh, 65, says, "We have taken it upon ourselves to not just rid our area but also the entire State of drugs. The Satrol khap, Nau-gama khap, and Bara khap (the names of various khaps active in Hisar and Hansi) have extended support to us, which has given our campaign new strength. Since then, we have become even more active and have started reaching out to every village grappling with the drug problem."

According to the police and locals, the drug crisis first took hold in Haryana's districts bordering Punjab and Rajasthan – Sirsa, Fatehabad, Jind, Kurukshetra, Kaithal, and Ambala – as heroin, locally known as *chitta*; poppy husk; and pharmaceutical drugs made their way across porous State borders. From these entry points, local dealers and small-time peddlers gradually built their own networks, carrying the trade deeper into the State's agricultural and semi-urban heartland, into districts such as Hisar, Hansi, Rohtak, Sonapat, and Panipat.

The trade has grown exponentially over the years. As per the Magnitude of Substance Use in India-2019 report, commissioned by the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment and conducted in collaboration with the National Drug Dependence Treatment Centre, All India Institute of Medical Sciences, New Delhi, 5.9 lakh people in Haryana need help for opioid-related problems. This is the third-highest number among States, after Uttar Pradesh (10.7 lakh) and Punjab (7.2 lakh).

Haryana is also among the States with the highest proportion of its population affected by opioid use, along with Punjab, Delhi, and several northeastern States – Mizoram, Nagaland, Arunachal Pradesh, Sikkim, and Manipur. The report estimates that 1.2 lakh people in Haryana need help for sedative use, putting it among the six States with the highest usage. Another 55,000 people in the State inject drugs, the sixth highest in the country.

As addiction has spread and concerns have grown over the efficacy of police action, villages have begun looking beyond the State machinery for ways to contain the problem. Khaps, social organisations, and gram sabhas have formed



We had reached a point where drug users and sellers had turned the village into a marketplace. People would enter homes and stand in queues to buy smack, *chitta*, ganja and other drugs.

ANIL GODARA
Brother-in-law of the Sarpanch in Rajthal village

committees to monitor suspected drug peddlers and even impose their own deterrents.

Keeping vigil

Residents say the drug problem in Rajthal, on the Jind-Hansi link road, has been around for nearly a decade, but it has worsened sharply over the past three years. They allege that the number of houses involved in selling drugs has increased from two or three to 25 or 26.

With the spread of drugs has come a rise in thefts, particularly from agricultural fields, say residents. They allege that to finance drug consumption, copper wires from submersible pumps, motorcycles, utensils, and other articles are stolen and sold as scrap.

"We had reached a point where drug users and sellers had turned the village into a marketplace," says Anil Godara, 38, the brother-in-law of Sarpanch Renu Devi. "People would enter homes and stand in queues to buy smack, *chitta*, ganja and other drugs."

According to Poonam Devi, 38, a yoga teacher working in the Haryana Kaushal Rozgar Nigam, a government department, the spread of drug use in Rajthal has changed the way women move through public spaces. "Those who use drugs stare in an improper manner at women. Sometimes they try to stop women riding scooters when they are returning from work," she says.

Devi says the bus stand has, in particular, become a place of concern. Women who park their scooters or motorcycles there are often warned by shopkeepers that their vehicles could be stolen by drug users. She says a bicycle and a motorcycle have been stolen from the area.

For girls and women going to school or college, the fear extends beyond theft. "We do not even feel safe wearing bangles or chains," she says. Women who once moved around the village freely in the mornings and evenings now often go out accompanied by men, she adds.



The poster in Rajthal warns that selling drugs in the village will attract a fine of ₹1 lakh; helping a drug peddler get bail will attract a fine of another ₹1 lakh. SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

Alarmed by the spread and addiction to drugs, locally known as *sukha nasha* (dry intoxicant), as well as the spurt in thefts, the residents of Rajthal approached the district administration and the police to seek their support in launching their initiative. They also held a gram sabha meeting, where residents across age groups agreed to participate in the campaign. The village then formed the *thekri pehra* at two points to keep a watch on people and vehicles entering and leaving Rajthal.

The *thekri pehra*, launched on August 26, involves groups of young men keeping watch, with 15-20 people stationed at each point after 9 p.m. During the day, the number of villagers, including the elderly, can rise to 50-60 or more. Village youth also ride motorcycles to chase people suspected of entering the village to buy drugs.

This practice has a history. The Punjab Village and Small Towns Patrol Act, 1918, outlines "the performance of nightly patrol duty by the inhabitants of villages...in case of emergency."

Residents say they have caught more than 400 people so far, including students, farmers, youth from well-off families, and a few girls aged 17-18. In several cases, parents have learned about their children's drug use only after the villagers informed them, say residents.

Ankur Bisla, 30, who is part of the *thekri pehra* team, says most of those caught consuming drugs are from Haryana, including neighbouring villages and areas around Panipat, Sirsa, and Sonapat. "Some of them had travelled from Gurugram as well," he says.

However, the job is not easy. After the vigil restricted the movement of outsiders into the village, drug sellers have become cleverer by taking supplies outside the village. Residents say they have noticed vehicles leaving the village in the wee hours, between 1 a.m. and 4 a.m.

Hansi Superintendent of Police Vinod Kumar says community participation has become an important part of the police campaign against drugs. In response to the villagers' demands for greater police presence, the police deployed four personnel, including a woman constable, along with a police control room vehicle and a checkpoint, a month after the campaign was launched.

On September 23, around 150 police personnel and a canine squad conducted a three-hour house-to-house search operation in the village. "But such operations can be challenging as people often get alerted by police activity and move or conceal contraband," he says.

When the people take over

Independent journalist Vijender Kumar, who runs a YouTube Channel called NewsMike24, says there is a history of illicit liquor trade in some of these villages. He says what was once largely confined to liquor has evolved into a more dangerous drug market, increasingly involving women too, and affecting the youth from poor families. The survey highlights the vulnerability of children: Haryana has 35,000 children who need help for inhalant use, the fourth-highest number among the five States with the highest figures.

The emergence of heroin is particularly worrying, says Kumar. He points out that 5.7 kg of heroin was seized in Jind alone a month ago, valued at around ₹11 crore in the international market.

Kumar says the fight against drugs in Haryana's villages is increasingly being led by residents. He recalls how Ashrafgarh-Dauri village in Jind, close to the Punjab border, confronted the problem about two years ago. "Villagers formed a 20-25-member team comprising the youth, government employees, retired people, and ex-servicemen to maintain round-the-clock vigil. They installed 25-26 CCTV cameras outside the houses of alleged drug sellers and imposed fines. The number of people coming into the village to buy drugs reduced," he says.

Lochab village, once a drug hotspot, also brought drug activity under control after the panchayat imposed fines and took strict action. "But



The police focus on curtailing the commercial supply of drugs, but the combination of the dark web, cryptocurrency, and courier services has changed the way drugs are trafficked.

RAJENDAR KUMAR MEENA
Deputy Inspector General of Police,
Haryana State Narcotics Control Bureau

new hotspots have emerged in Rajthal, Petwar, and Sulchani, where drug supply remains high," says Kumar.

Rajthal resident Ratan Sharma says the police are reluctant to conduct searches in cases involving small quantities of drugs. "They say they cannot register a case over one or two packets. But if searches are not conducted, how will larger quantities be recovered," he asks.

Sagar Preet Hooda, Director General of Police (DGP), Chandigarh, and a native of Haryana's Rohtak, has conceptualised a village-based programme that brings local residents together to tackle the growing drug problem as a community-led social intervention. Called the Panchgama development model, the programme will be launched in Jind on October 11. In its first phase, it will cover nearly 300 villages, grouped into 60 clusters of five villages each.

"Through the Jind social forum, volunteers with roots in Haryana will share their experiences, expertise, and networks to support rural youth. They will work alongside existing community and government institutions," he says.

Several khaps, too, have announced that they will impose fines on those indulging in drug-peddling in view of the growing problem.

Even as communities are taking matters into their own hands, Bisla questions the lack of political will in dealing with the growing menace. "On the one hand, the BJP has launched the Nasha Mukht Punjab Yatra (an anti-drug political campaign) in neighbouring Punjab. On the other, it has done precious little to contain the menace in the State that it has governed for the past 12 years," he says.

State measures and hurdles

As part of its efforts to combat the drug menace, the State government constituted the Haryana State Narcotics Control Bureau (HSNCB) on August 25, 2020. So far, 2,353 FIRs involving commercial quantities of narcotics have been registered under the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Act, 1985, and 6,256 accused people have been arrested, according to a press conference held in June this year by Additional Director General of Police, HSNCB.

In a parallel crackdown on drug-derived wealth, assets worth ₹72.70 crore have been seized, frozen, or attached to date. As part of the campaign against habitual and organised traffickers, preventive detention orders were issued against 156 accused under the Prevention of Illicit Traffic in Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Act, 1988. In addition, property attachment proceedings were initiated against 432 individuals to target illegally acquired assets generated by the drug trade.

Rajendar Kumar Meena, Deputy Inspector General of Police, HSNCB, says that going by drug seizures, heroin is the most prevalent in the districts bordering Delhi – Gurugram, Faridabad, Jhajjar – followed by cocaine, MDMA (a synthetic psychoactive drug), ganja, and poppy straw. "The police have a three-pronged strategy to combat the drug menace – enforcement, awareness, and de-addiction," says Meena, conceding that supply cannot be totally curtailed till the time that there is demand.

"The police focus on curtailing the commercial supply of drugs, but the combination of the dark web, cryptocurrency, and courier services has changed the way drugs are trafficked."

The gaps in rehabilitation

Vipin Sharma, the founder of Ankush Foundation, a drug rehabilitation centre in Hisar, says Haryana's response to addiction remains focused on de-addiction and regulatory compliance and gives little attention to long-term rehabilitation.

After more than two decades in the field, Sharma, a recovering addict himself, says the biggest problem is that policies are often framed without consulting those delivering services, such as rehabilitation and de-addiction programmes, on ground.

Sharma argues that frequent inspections and increasingly prescriptive rules have made it harder for rehabilitation centres to function effectively. "Rules requiring clinical psychologists at every centre don't take into account the limited availability of trained professionals. There is also excessive focus on specifications, such as the distance between beds. These requirements divert attention from the central problem of treating addiction," he says.

For Sharma, the largest gap is the absence of sustained rehabilitation after medical treatment. "De-addiction is a medical treatment. It can address physical dependence on a substance, but it is not the complete solution," he says. "Without long-term rehabilitation, a patient's psychological dependence is not addressed."

Sharma says Haryana lacks a rehabilitation centre run or supported entirely by the State government (there are eight centres in the State supported by the Union government). Private centres operate without government assistance, but face regulatory and licensing hurdles.

An inmate at the rehabilitation centre says, "For an addict, quitting drugs is only the beginning. The real battle is staying away from them – a struggle that can last a lifetime." Recovery, he says, cannot end at the centre's gates; it requires the continued support of family and society to help those battling addiction rebuild their lives and find their way back into the mainstream.

From Page One

Congress leads protests seeking CEC exit, arrest

The Congress has framed the protests around its “vote *chori*” campaign, alleging that the electoral-roll revision process could exclude legitimate voters. The protests followed Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi’s press conference on Thursday on the issue, after a news report that two of the three Election Commissioners, Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi, had repeatedly objected over a period of 10 months to decisions on the electoral rolls, saying that some of the decisions were taken without their knowledge.

In several States, party workers burnt effigies of the CEC, raised slogans demanding his arrest and called for an independent review of the electoral rolls. Protests were reported in Lucknow, where Congress workers led by State president Ajay Rai clashed with the police after being stopped. In Assam, State Congress president Gaurav Gogoi and other leaders were detained when they attempted to march towards the Chief Electoral Officer’s office. In Jammu, Congress MP and AICC general secretary Syed Naseer Hussain led the protest, with several senior party leaders, including former Ministers and former legislators, participating in the demonstration.

‘SC/ST MPs not given enough time to speak’

“This issue was flagged by many who were present at the meeting. Moreover, this was something that was discussed informally. Sometimes we get the opportunity and sometimes we don’t. Of course, all parliamentarians want more floor time,” he said.

Mr. Manjhi told *The Hindu* that the NDA MPs’ groups meet once every quarter. “These meetings are designed to give a platform to the NDA parliamentarians to air their grievances, and the leader chairing the group then conveys these concerns to the respective Ministry or department. At the August 5 meeting, Mr. Patel raised the issue on behalf of several first-time MPs from the SC and ST communities. Everyone should have the right to speak in Parliament. That is what I conveyed in my letter to the Speaker,” he said.

Recently, Mr. Manjhi made headlines for supporting the sub-categorisation of SC/ST reservation and the introduction of a creamy layer within reservation. He argued that the benefits of SC reservation were reaching only some relatively empowered Dalit communities, while extremely marginalised groups such as the Musahar and Musahar-Bhuiyan communities, which fall under the Mahadalit category, continued to be deprived of these benefits.

His Cabinet colleague from Bihar and LJP (RV) chief Chirag Paswan opposed the idea and argued that reservation is based not on economic status but on historical “social discrimination and untouchability”.

Govt., banks to decide subsidy amount for UPI

Both officials confirmed that the Ministry of Petroleum will be engaging with the petroleum dealers and their associations to work on their issues regarding MDR. The dealers’ associations have voiced their concerns about the charge and have asked for a waiver.

“The MDR issue for the dealers is that it will impact their profit margins, and so they have used this as a reason to ask for a review of the margin amount that is decided by them and the Petroleum Ministry,” one of the officials explained. “The Petroleum Ministry will be taking this up with them.”

There is no proposal to waive MDR for them, the officials added.

Declaration part of Form 6 changed since SIR in Bihar

The Election Commission uses Form 6 for fresh voter registrations; new voters are now required to furnish details from last SIR, including Assembly constituency, polling booth and serial numbers

Sreeparna Chakrabarty
NEW DELHI

The declaration accompanying Form 6, which was introduced for the first time during the first phase of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) in Bihar last year, has undergone substantial changes in the later phases. The Election Commission uses Form 6 for fresh voter registrations.

In Bihar, the declaration form was sought to confirm the exact period of the birth of a new voter, whether it was before 1987, between 1987 and 2004, or after 2004, based on which the prospective voter had to submit documents.

For those born before July 1, 1987, only the applicant’s own document was needed to prove date and or place of birth; for those born between July 1, 1987 and December 2, 2004, the applicant needed their own document, along with one parent’s document (either father’s or mother’s); for those born after December 2, 2004, the applicant needed their own document, with documents for both parents



Fresh tweaks: New voters filling Form 6 had to declare whether their or their parents’ names appeared in the last SIR. FILE PHOTO

(father’s and mother’s) establishing date/place of birth.

If either parent was not an Indian citizen, a copy of that parent’s valid passport and visa (valid at the time of the applicant’s birth) also had to be submitted.

Change in second phase

In the second phase of SIR, new voters filling Form 6 had to declare whether their or their parents’ names appeared in the last SIR. They also had to give the Assembly constituency number and polling booth number and the serial number at which the names appeared in the electoral rolls of the last

SIR. While filling the form online in the second phase, if the applicant did not have this information, they could choose the third option, on the ECINet portal. Though the field was not formally marked “mandatory”, in practice, applicants could not submit the online form without completing it. This addition in the form continued in the third phase, which was announced in May this year.

It is this issue that Election Commissioners Vivek Joshi and Sukhbir Singh Sandhu flagged in separate notes and letters in May 2026 and August 2026, respectively.

Plea in SC seeks SIT probe against CEC, audit of poll body

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

A petition filed in the Supreme Court on Friday sought the constitution of an independent, high-powered Judicial Inquiry Commission or Special Investigation Team headed by a retired judge of the top court to probe allegations against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar.

The plea said such an investigation must encompass, among others, an end-to-end audit of the Election Commission databases and probe the institutional circumstances under which 13 crore names were deleted across 30 States/Union Territories under the Special Intensive Revision (SIR).

The plea filed by Supreme Court advocate Shailendra Mani Tripathi, represented by advocate Chand Qureshi, submitted that Mr. Kumar, in light of the allegations, would be divested of any statutory or constitutional immunity, the CEC remains directly accountable under the law – subject to police investigation, evidence gathering, and regular trial proceedings as an “ordinary accused”.

Mr. Tripathi argued that

The plea submitted that the CEC remains directly accountable under the law as an ‘ordinary accused’

the allegations raised against Mr. Kumar in an investigative newspaper report did not show any reasonable nexus with his official functions and responsibilities, and included tampering with the electoral roll.

‘No reasonable nexus’

The allegations constitute a cognisable offence under Section 32 of the Representation of the People Act, 1950 as well as the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS).

“Once the logical and legal coherence between the act and the official obligation ceases to exist, the doctrine of ‘reasonable nexus’ breaks down completely. In the absence of this legal nexus, the statutory protection available under Section 16 of the Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners Act, 2023 becomes entirely ineffective,” the petition contended.

The petition was filed after *The Indian Express* expose on the poll body.

Patnaik calls for thorough review of the SIR process

Satyasundar Barik
BHUBANESWAR

Biju Janata Dal president and former Odisha Chief Minister Naveen Patnaik on Friday demanded the resignation of the Chief Election Commissioner following a media expose that pointed out differences in the Election Commission about the Special Intensive Revision.

“Because of strong and sharp differences between various Election Commissioners, the CEC should immediately resign. And the entire process of SIR should be thoroughly revisited,” he said. The BJD has been against the SIR process from the beginning, he said.

“The SIR 2026 process was initiated by mapping the 2025 electoral data. Instead of simplifying the process, it was deliberately made complicated. As a result, voters were excluded,” the BJD said.

Mamata, CPI(M) bridge decades-old divide with discussion on EC row

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

Setting aside decades-long differences, former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee spoke to Communist Party of India (Marxist) general secretary M.A. Baby on Friday, with both leaders converging on the question of the “declining credibility” of the Election Commission (EC).

The call is unprecedented and comes against the backdrop of a rivalry spanning nearly three decades. Ms. Banerjee quit the Congress to form the Trinamool Congress in 1997 because she believed the Congress’s State leadership was too soft on the ruling CPI(M)-led Left Front. In 2011, she managed to defeat the 34-year-old Left Front government. The CPI(M) remained the most strident critic of Ms. Banerjee’s 15-year reign, which ended with the 2026 Assembly election.

Friday’s phone call



The CPI (M)’s women’s group holds a protest against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar in Kolkata on Friday. ANI

came as a result of an outreach led by Mr. Baby following the recent *Indian Express* report that Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar allegedly ignored objections raised by fellow Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi regarding various decisions related to the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls. He had written to leaders of multiple political parties exhorting them to respond to the “extraordinary situation”.

Mr. Baby wrote the let-

ter, dated September 23, to parties working both within and outside the Opposition INDIA bloc. Beyond the INDIA bloc, he reached out to the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK), the Bharat Rashtira Samithi (BRS), the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP), and the Biju Janata Dal (BJD). He also sent the same appeal to the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), which is not registered as a political party.

In his letter, Mr. Baby wrote that to protect “constitutional values” and “citizens’ right to vote”, it is

essential that all political outfits meet and deliberate with the “urgency that the situation warrants”.

“The people of our country are looking at us with the hope that all of us will stand in defence of democracy, secularism and the right to vote,” he said, asking the parties to find a mutually convenient date and place for the meeting.

Ms. Banerjee, according to sources, was one of the first leaders to respond to Mr. Baby’s plea.

Agreeing with him, she wrote, “This is truly an extraordinary situation in which the credibility of the EC and our democracy is at stake.” The two leaders spoke over the phone on Friday in a call that sources described as “warm”. According to sources, Ms. Banerjee also informed Mr. Baby that she had reached out to Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi to call a meeting of the INDIA bloc at the earliest.

Congress, Left demand CEC’s resignation in Kolkata rallies

Shrabana Chatterjee
KOLKATA

Hundreds took part in two different protests in Kolkata on Friday demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar and the initiation of legal proceedings against him over issues related to the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in the country.

The separate rallies were organised by the Congress party and the Left-affiliated women’s rights group, All India Democratic Women’s Association (AIDWA). Protesters in the Congress rally burned an effigy of the CEC.

During the AIDWA rally, protesters marched towards the West Bengal Chief Electoral Officer’s (CEO’s) office to demand the reinstatement of what they alleged were names “wrongfully” deleted under SIR.

Students, Oppn. protest seeking CEC’s resignation, arrest; several detained

Lavpreet Kaur
Ashna Butani
NEW DELHI



AISA activist Neha Bora being detained during a protest demanding the resignation and arrest of Gyanesh Kumar on Friday. PTI

Protests demanding the resignation and arrest of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar were held at Jantar Mantar and near Nirvachan Sadan on Friday, with police detaining students and political workers. However, later in the evening, protesters said all those detained had been released.

The All India Students’ Association (AISA) called a protest at Jantar Mantar over what it described as the “compromise of the Election Commission”, while the Delhi Congress marched from ITO towards Nirvachan Sadan. The Stu-

dents’ Federation of India (SFI) and the Congress’s student and youth wings also held protests.

New Delhi Deputy Commissioner of Police Sachin Sharma said no permission had been sought or granted for the Jantar Mantar protest. Police initially said

90 protesters were detained there. Delhi Congress president Devender Yadav and AISA activist Nehra Bora were among those detained.

“The agitation would continue until Gyanesh Kumar is arrested and voters whose names had alleged-

ly been deleted are restored to the electoral rolls,” said Ms. Bora.

Former Jawaharlal Nehru University Students’ Union president N. Sai Balaji alleged that police personnel without name tags manhandled protesters and that around 200 people remained detained at 7 p.m. Police denied the allegations, saying all personnel wore name tags and only necessary force was used.

The general secretary of Communist Party of India (Marxist-Leninist) Liberation, Dipankar Bhattacharya accused the Election Commission of undermining the electoral process and demanded Mr. Kumar’s removal.

Lawyers’ group seeks fresh hearing in CEC law challenge and Noida DM case

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A group of advocates issued a public statement on Friday seeking the recall of a recent Supreme Court order involving Noida District Magistrate Medha Roopam and requesting that petitions challenging the Chief Election Commissioner’s appointment law be heard afresh.

The statement, issued by the Lawyers Association for Constitution and circulated online by Supreme Court advocate Subhash Chandran K.R., urges that both matters be heard by a top court Bench that does not include Justice Satish Chandra Sharma.

Justice Sharma had led

Lawyers urge both matters be heard by an apex court Bench that does not include Justice Sharma

the Division Bench that passed an interim order on September 23 in the appeal filed by Ms. Roopam, the daughter of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar.

Split decision

The same day saw Justice Sharma disagree with Justice Dipankar Datta on whether the challenge against the 2023 CEC/EC law should be referred to a five-judge Bench. Justice Datta had decided against

the reference to a Constitution Bench, opting to straightaway hear the merits of the case against the 2023 law while Justice Sharma had favoured a reference.

Due to the split decision, the matter is now pending before the Chief Justice of India to constitute a Constitution Bench, causing further delay in a final ruling.

The lawyers’ group has cited two primary concerns gleaned from public reports. One, on the “improper listing” of Ms. Roopam’s case before Justice Sharma’s Bench, which did not hold the roster for petitions linked to *habeas corpus* pleas. The association further pointed to “public

reports” stating that the “son of Justice Sharma is empanelled as a standing counsel for the Election Commission of India before the High Court of Madhya Pradesh”.

“We do not know whether this was brought to the notice of the parties in either matter... We wish to state that we are not on the merits of the case but on how these circumstances may appear to the public. The Supreme Court has long held that the test in such situations is not whether a judge was in fact influenced. The test is whether a fair-minded and informed observer might reasonably apprehend a possibility of bias,” the statement said.

Govt. yet to decide how open-field caste data will be sorted, tabulated

Opposition, OBC groups are against open-column option in 2027 Census; they say 2011 Socio-Economic Caste Census also had an open field to record caste, yielding over 46 lakh caste names; successive governments did not act on it, they add

Abhinav Lakshman
NEW DELHI

More than a month after the Union government notified the questionnaire for the second phase of the 2027 Census, finalising an open-column method to record caste, officials told *The Hindu* that a decision is yet to be taken on how the government will sort, tabulate, and rationalise the data collected through this method.

Under this method, people who are not from the Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes can enter their caste names in an open column. This is unlike other modes of enumerating castes wherein people have to choose from a list of castes, a method used by the Bihar and Telangana governments in their caste surveys. The open-field method allows people to opt for a “no-caste” option; they can al-



The questions in the second phase include those on caste and fields for family particulars and COVID vaccinations. C. VENKATACHALAPATHY

so choose not to disclose their caste name.

Experts, Opposition parties, and associations representing Other Backward Classes have criticised the decision to use the open-column method, arguing that it is bound to repeat the results of the 2011 Socio-Economic Caste Census exercise, which yielded over 46 lakh different caste names. Successive governments had shelved that report, they

say. A senior government official said that discussions on how to make sense of the caste data returned through the 2027 Census forms have not yet been initiated, adding that this will happen as the fieldwork on the exercise progresses over the coming months.

Apart from the caste question, which has been introduced in India's census forms for the first time since Independence, the

method of sorting and tabulating the data for the other new questions is also in various stages of discussion within the Office of the Census Commissioner.

13 new questions

The second phase of the 2027 Census exercise lists a total of 40 questions, of which 13 are new questions or data fields that were not part of the previous 2011 census. These include the question on caste and fields for family particulars, ID proofs, and COVID vaccinations.

The government official added that once a holistic proposal is prepared by the Office of the Registrar General and Census Commissioner of India on the method for sorting the data, this file is sent up the chain to the Union Home Secretary, following which the government will take a final decision, either at the level of the Ministry or the Union Cabinet.

Officials said that each division of the Census office would have to handle the tabulation process for the questions that they are responsible for, after which the file on this methodology is forwarded to the top bureaucrat in the Union Home Ministry.

Speaking to *The Hindu*, Professor G.N. Devy, scholar, linguist, and cultural activist, said the Office of the Census Commissioner should have ideally included experts in the discussions on finalising the questions, adding that doubts about the method of post-data collection analysis would have also been addressed at this stage, had the government taken this approach.

The second phase of the Census has already begun in several hilly and remote regions, such as Ladakh and the snow-bound areas of Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, and Jammu and Kashmir.

J&K CM brings Statehood resolution in Assembly amid loud protests by BJP

Peerzada Ashiq
SRINAGAR

Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah on Friday moved a resolution on the restoration of Statehood “in continuation of the 2000 autonomy resolution” and evoked protests from the Opposition BJP legislators, who tore the resolution, climbed the tables and opposed any move to discuss autonomy or Article 370 in the Assembly.

“In addition to the Resolutions passed by this House on 26th June 2000 and 6th November 2024, this House calls upon the Government of India for the immediate and urgent restoration of full Statehood to Jammu and Kashmir and resolves that this Resolution be forwarded to Government of India,” reads the resolution moved by Mr. Abdullah in the Supplementary List of Business.

The Chief Minister said this resolution will “neither replace or subsume previous resolutions of the Assembly” like in 2000 and 2024 on autonomy and special status, respectively.

‘Not unconstitutional’

“We own those resolutions. This resolution is in addition to those resolutions. No one should misconstrue that we are just demanding Statehood and forget about the past resolutions. This is not an unconstitutional resolution,” said Mr. Abdullah.

He said the resolution was purely based on logic. “Not a single anti-national word in it. We have not brought any fresh resolution on autonomy as that already stands passed and is the property of the House,” said Mr. Abdullah.



House uproar: BJP members stage a protest in the J&K Legislative Assembly on Friday. IMRAN NISSAR

He said the fresh resolution was necessitated because the resolution of the Cabinet was not considered the voice of the people. “A resolution from the legislature reflects the will of the entire political spectrum of J&K. Statehood is not about any government, my family or an individual. It is about the entire J&K,” said Mr. Abdullah.

He said this resolution is “merely for the Centre to restore Statehood of J&K”. “Unfortunately, the BJP legislators do not want it. The BJP legislators should have allowed the Speaker to initiate a debate. They could have taken a stand in their speeches. But they don’t want to vote for Statehood and all 29 BJP legislators stand as a hurdle to Statehood. The BJP MLAs should neither abstain, nor walk out but vote for or against the resolution,” said Mr. Abdullah.

Parties lend support

Besides the ruling ally Congress and CPI(M), the legislators of the Peoples Democratic Party (PDP), Awami Ittehad Party (AIP) and J&K Peoples Conference (JKPC), also extended their support for the resolution.

“J&K’s accession to India rests on 1947 promises. Statehood is not a matter

of charity,” said JKPC chief and legislator Sajad Lone. PDP legislator Aga Syed Muntazir Mehdi also flashed a placard in favour of Article 370 in the House.

Noisy scenes

Meanwhile, the mention of the 2000 autonomy resolution, which had called for a greater autonomy of the region and was later rejected by Parliament, sparked an uproar from BJP MLAs. They tore the NC resolution, stormed into the Well of the House and climbed onto tables, forcing the Speaker to adjourn the session for half-an-hour. However, noisy scenes continued when the Assembly resumed again. “We are ready to discuss Statehood but this resolution is controversial and disputed. The BJP had rejected the autonomy resolution. Congress should clear its position, from Rahul Gandhi to the State Chief of Congress. Is it with this resolution? Is it with the pre-1953 resolution? Is it with the resolution of [Article] 370, or is it with the government?” said BJP legislator and Leader of Opposition Sunil Sharma.

“So-called autonomy, so-called resolution of 370” will not be allowed to be admitted here, he added.

Trinamool leader Ajit Maity held in extortion case

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

The West Bengal Police on Friday arrested Mamata All India Trinamool Congress leader Ajit Maity on charges of extortion. Mr. Maity was arrested from the Pingla police station on charges of taking money from a person named Gautam Das. According to the allegation made by Mr. Das, Mr. Maity had promised him a post in the party in return for the money.

Mr. Maity was arrested from his residence in Kharagpur and taken to the Debra police station.

Mr. Maity won the Pingla constituency in the 2021 Assembly election. However, in 2026, he contested from the same constituency and lost to the BJP candidate. He is currently the Vice-President of the Midnapore Zilla Parishad.

Calcutta HC overturns relief to Congress Nandigram bypoll candidate in 2007 case

Press Trust of India
KOLKATA

A Division Bench of the Calcutta High Court on Friday set aside a Single-Judge Bench order granting relief to the Congress’s Nandigram byelection candidate, Milan Pradhan, from coercive action in a 2007 criminal case.

The Division Bench, presided over by Chief Justice Ravindra Vithalrao Ghuge, held that there was no provision in criminal

law for such interim protection to an accused. It said an accused has the liberty to seek bail after arrest and, if apprehending arrest, can apply for anticipatory bail.

The Bench set aside Thursday’s order directing the police not to take any steps against Mr. Pradhan in the case till October 12.

The Bench observed that the law is the same for everyone and there cannot be a different consideration for a person contest-

ing an election. With the single-Bench order set aside, Mr. Pradhan’s judicial remand till October 7, granted by the Contai ACJM Court, will remain effective. On Thursday, Justice Saugata Bhattacharyya directed the police not to take any steps against Mr. Pradhan till October 12 in connection with the 2007 case at the Khejuri police station in Purba Medinipur district.

Mr. Pradhan was arrested by the Purba Medinipur

district police on September 18 and was shown arrested in connection with the case. The Contai court on Wednesday remanded him in judicial custody till October 7.

Mr. Pradhan faces charges, including of murder and attempt to murder, in the 2007 case linked to the anti-land acquisition movement in Nandigram.

The byelection is scheduled for October 6, with campaigning ending on October 4.

Shaunak sails for Australia with QUAD officers onboard

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Indian Coast Guard (ICG) ship *Shaunak* sailed from Chennai on Friday for Perth as part of the QUAD-at-Sea Ship Observer Mis-

sion, aimed at enhancing maritime interoperability and professional exchanges among India, Australia, Japan and the U.S. The team on board comprises two officers each from India and Japan and one officer each from Australia and the U.S.

राजस्थान सरकार
कार्यालय-निदेशक, पुरातत्व एवं संग्रहालय विभाग, राजस्थान, जयपुर।
अलखंडल परिसर, रामनगर बाग, जयपुर।
दूरभाष सं. 0141-2820380 (मेल- dirarchraj@gmail.com)
क्रमांक : पुसो/0/2026/21186 दिनांक : 22.09.2026

:- ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या-11/2026-27 :-

राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से इस विभाग के अधीन निम्नलिखित यू.पी.एन. नामक के कार्य हेतु राज्य सरकार/राजकीय उपकरणों/केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग/केन्द्र सरकार/भारतीय पुरातत्व सर्वेक्षण आदि में सम्बन्धित कार्य हेतु निम्नानुसार सूचना श्रेणी में पंजीकृत सर्वेक्षकों/फर्मों से ई-मोली प्रक्रिया से वेबसाइट <http://eproc.raajasthan.gov.in> पर ऑनलाईन निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत जानकारी वेबसाइट www.dior.raajasthan.gov.in, <http://sppp.raajasthan.gov.in> व विभागीय वेबसाइट <http://museumrajasthan.gov.in> पर देखी व काउनलोड की सकती है-

NIB No.	UBN No.
AMD2627A0048	AMD2627WSOB00074

DIPR/C/16328/2026

(आरक्षीय मुनी)
अधिसापी अधिनयना

**OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER
WATER RESOURCES ZONE, BHARATPUR**
sinchai Workshop, Near Collectrate office Bharatpur,
E-mail- wrzonebpr@gmail.com

No. Accts/2026-27/2335 Date : 22/09/2026

e-NIB No.- 08/2026-27

On behalf of the Governor of Rajasthan, bids are invited from eligible bidders for the work of -"Construction of Lift (drainage) scheme from Naval Kund & Apsara Kund Punchari to Goverdhan Drain and Renovation & Beautification of Radha Prem & Rasik Ananya Sarovar Jateri Dham Distt Deeg." (Estimated value of work is Rs. 671.90 Lac) Last date of submission of Bid is 13/10/2026. Detailed Bid & Bid document can be seen on & downloaded from official website (<http://eproc.raajasthan.gov.in>, & <http://sppp.raj.nic.in>)

NIB Code No.: WRD2627A0325
UBN No.:- WRD2627WLOB00683

**Additional Chief Engineer
WRD, Zone Bharatpur**

DIPR/C/16328/2026

STATE INFRASTRUCTURE & INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION OF UTTARAKHAND LTD.
Regional Office, SIIDCUL, Selaqui, Dehradun. Web site : www.siidcul.com

NIT-03/SIIDCUL/Selaqui/2026 Dated 25.09.2026

Short Term Tender Notice

SIIDCUL invites online bids for "Repair and Maintenance of Existing Kerb stone and Road Resurfacing work at Pharmacy, Selaqui, Dehradun." The tender document would be available from 26.09.2026 till submission date i.e. 17.10.2026 up to 14.00 Hrs. Tender document can be downloaded from <http://www.uktenders.gov.in> or www.siidcul.com. Corrigendum (if any) will be uploaded on the above websites only.

Regional Manager

कार्यालय अधिसापी अधिनयना, सा.नि.वि.जिला खण्ड प्रथम, उदयपुर
चौधबस्ती केम्पस प्रथम तल मुनास बाग रोड, गिरा पीर हारस उदयपुर- 313001
E-Mail:- xenddiudaiupr.pwd@rajasthan.gov.in
Email:- eeddiudaiudaiupr@gmail.com संपर्क नंर 0294-2428933

NO -920 Date:- 17.09.2026

NIT No. 07/2026-2027

Notice Inviting Bid

Bids for "Various Road's & Building Construction, Renewal, Strengthening Works in various schemes in District Udaipur (Raj.) are invited from interested bidders upto 6.00 PM, dated 08.10.2026

Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<http://ercp.raajasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.raj.nic.in>) of the Rajasthan and <http://pwd.raajasthan.gov.in> website. The approximate value of the procurement is Rs. 368.72 Lacs.

NIB :- PWD2627A2804
1-UBN No :- PWD2627WSOB12488 2-UBN No :- PWD2627WSOB12491
3-UBN No :- PWD2627WSOB12487 4-UBN No :- PWD2627WSOB12503

Your's faithfully
(B.S. Meena)
Executive Engineer
Public Works Department
Distt Dn I Udaipur

DIPR/C/16391/2026

KERALA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LTD
(DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH & FAMILY WELFARE, GOVT. OF KERALA)
Head Office : Thycaud, Thiruvananthapuram-14,
(Telephone No. 0471-2945600, 2945646)
E-mail : edrgs.kmscl@kerala.gov.in,
website : www.kmscl.kerala.gov.in, CIN No. U24233KL2007SGC021616

No.KMSCL/ED/6/2026 Date : 26.09.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

Online bids are invited for the **Procurement of Drugs for Rare Diseases** for Department of Health & Family Welfare, Govt of Kerala for the year 2026-27.

Sl. No.	Tender No. and Date	No. of Items
1.	KMSCL/ED/RD-SAT-2/RC/2026/022 dtd. 26.09.2026	6

Schedule of dates

	Date	Time
Last date of online uploading of tenders	12.10.2026	05.00pm.
Date of technical bid opening	14.10.2026	11.00 am.

Tender document shall be downloaded and submitted online through the e-tender portal www.etenders.kerala.gov.in.

(Sd/-) MANAGING DIRECTOR (Tender Inviting Authority)

**GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
HIGHER EDUCATION DEPARTMENT**
Lokseva Bhawan, Sachivalaya Marg, Bhubaneswar-751001
HE-SCH-PLAN-0037-2026/51755 /HE.. Bhubaneswar, Dated : 24.09.2026

Corrigendum-I

NOTICE INVITING RFP FOR PROCUREMENT, SUPPLY, INSTALLATION & COMMISSIONING OF LABORATORY EQUIPMENT & ITS ACCESSORIES FOR MAHARAJA SRIRAM CHANDRA BHANJA DEO UNIVERSITY, MAYURBHANJ UNDER REGIONAL DIRECTORATE OF EDUCATION, BALASHWAR APPROVED UNDER PM-USHA.

RFP No. PM-USHA:04/2026 Date: 05.09.2026

Sl. No.	RFP Cl. No.	Page No.	Description as per RFP	Now Modified Provisions
1		4	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 28/09/2026 (till 4:00 PM) (Registered Post & Speed Post only)	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 12/10/2026 till 4:00 PM) (Registered Post & Speed Post only)
2		4	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 30/09/2026 at 4:00 PM	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 14/10/2026 at 4:00 PM

All other terms and conditions of the RFP remain unchanged.

Joint Secretary to Govt. & SPD, RUSA / PM-USHA
11001/338/2627 OIPR-11001/11001/1/26-27/0062

KERALA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LTD.
(Department of Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of Kerala)
THYCAUD PO., THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - 695014
Telephone No. 0471-2945600, 2945600
website: www.kmscl.kerala.gov.in, e-mail: edrgs.kmscl@kerala.gov.in
CIN No. U24233KL2007SGC021616

No. KMSCL/EP/215/2026 Dated : 25.09.2026

e-TENDER NOTICE (Running Contract)

Online bids are invited for the supply and installation of the following equipment for various Government healthcare institutions across Kerala

Sl. No	Tender No.	Description	Online Pre-Bid Meeting	Last date of Online submission
1.	T598/2026	Robotic Surgical System	05.10.2026 11.00 am.	17.10.2026 5.00 p.m.
2.	T599/2026	MRI Compatible Anesthesia work station, MR Compatible Multiparameter Monitor, Cardiac 3D Mapping system, CT Scanner 256 Slice, Pituitary & Vascular doppler.	08.10.2026 11.00 am.	22.10.2026 5.00 p.m.
3.	T600/2026	Cardiac Cath lab with EP Facility Model A, Cardiac Cath lab with EP Facility Model B, Clinical flow cytometer, Bipolar Cautery with sheath for Laparoscopy.	09.10.2026 11.00 am.	22.10.2026 5.00 p.m.
4.	T601/2026	Medical Gas Pipe Line System Model A, Medical Gas Pipe Line System Model B, Intra Vascular Ultrasound (IVUS) Machine and Fractional Flow Reserve machine (FFR) Capability, Operating Microscope with adjustable Arms for Plastic Surgery.	13.10.2026 11.00 am.	24.10.2026 5.00 p.m.
5.	T602/2026	Multiparameter Monitor with Capnogram and IPM, Multiparameter Monitor with Anesthesia gas Monitor, Multifunctional Couch with IV Fluid Stand, Dialysis Consumables, Patient warmer, Suction low pressure, Ventilator CPAP (Noninvasive)	N.A.	09.10.2026 5.00 p.m.
6.	T603/2026	Sequential Compression Devices Calf Pump, Stretcher trolley higher End with CPR Facility, Ultrasonic cleaner, Pharmacy Refrigerator 1000 litre, Modular cold chamber Model B, Micro Centrifuge, Walk in cold Room, Bicarbonate mixer, RO Plant 1000 LPH, RO Plant 3000 LPH, Yag Laser for Glaucoma Clinic, Power Laundry machine, Iron Cot, Noninvasive BIPAP Ventilator, Suction Apparatus	N.A.	12.10.2026 5.00 p.m.
7.	T604 (Ry) 2026	MRI Scanner 1.5 Tesla Normal Bore (Helium Free), Linear Accelerator (LINAC) Ring Gantry, Advanced Phaco Emulsification System, Isoelectric Focusing for Newborn Screening Hematology Analyzer 5 Part Model B, High Speed Centrifuge, Digital Vortex Mixer, Anaerobic Chamber Glove Box, Refrigerated Centrifuge, Dental Laser, Transvaginal Uterine Artery Clamp, Automated CPR System Model B, Schiotz Tonometer, Orbital Atherectomy System, Intra Oral Digital Radiographic System Type B, Micromanipulator System with accessories, Therapeutic Apheresis Machine, HD Laparoscopic System, HD Laparoscopic Instruments, Ergometer, Active Passive Exercise System for Upper and Lower Extremity, Sperm Fuge, Microdebrider for ENT, Body Box for Plethysmography, Tissue Homogenizer, Retractor Set, Diathermy Surgical, Electric Hot air Oven (Dental), Vortex Mixture, 2.5 mm Arthroscope with Trocar and Cannula, PCR Reagents and Kits	N.A.	09.10.2026 5.00 p.m.

Tender documents and all other information related to tender and bidding process can be downloaded from the website www.etenders.kerala.gov.in.
(Sd/-) Managing Director (Tender Inviting Authority)

A ND-NDE

INBRIEF



‘No commitment made to unions on 5-day work week’

Rejecting claims of bank employee unions regarding a commitment to implement a five-day work week, government sources said there was no commitment on the issue from the Finance Ministry. Bank employee unions under the United Forum of Bank Unions have announced a three-day strike from September 28 to press for their demands, including a five-day work week. The strike, if it materialises, would coincide with the banking sector's half-yearly close. PTI

India should allow exchanges to list on own platform: NSE

India's markets regulator should reconsider allowing exchanges to list on their own platforms, NSE Chairman Srinivas Injeti said on Friday, a day after the bourse operator debuted on rival BSE at a valuation of about \$47 billion. SEBI debated allowing self-listing in 2015 but rejected the idea over potential conflicts of interest, requiring their shares to trade on rival bourses. However, self-listing is permitted in several major global markets. REUTERS

TRAI launches digital rating platform for properties

The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) on Friday launched an integrated Digital Connectivity Rating (DCR) platform and a dedicated mobile app to assess and certify in-building mobile and internet connectivity across residential, commercial, and government properties. The platform is designed to enable prospective buyers and tenants to evaluate digital readiness prior to purchasing or leasing. PTI

Coffee Board brews sustainability push with new framework

M. Soundariya Preetha
COIMBATORE

The Coffee Board has developed sustainability standards and is in the process of implementing the certification process, said Kurma Rao, its Chief Executive Officer and Secretary.

India, the world's seventh-largest coffee producer and fifth-largest exporter, exported coffee worth more than \$2 billion in 2025-26, with nearly 39% comprising value-added products., he said.

Indian coffee's distinctive advantage lies in its traditional shade-grown cultivation, which the Board

aims to leverage through the new sustainability standards.

“We have published the standards. We are in the process of implementing the certification and a steering committee has been formed for it,” he told *The Hindu*.

The certification will be done at three levels - first will be done by the Board based on self certification by the growers. The second level will involve independent third-party verification, while the third level will benchmark Indian standards against internationally recognised sustainability frameworks.

AI-led phone price hikes persist, hitting Indian customers

A series of price hikes has put budget phones out of reach for many who choose to wait for festival discounts or settle for 'less-powerful' devices

Aroon Deep
NEW DELHI

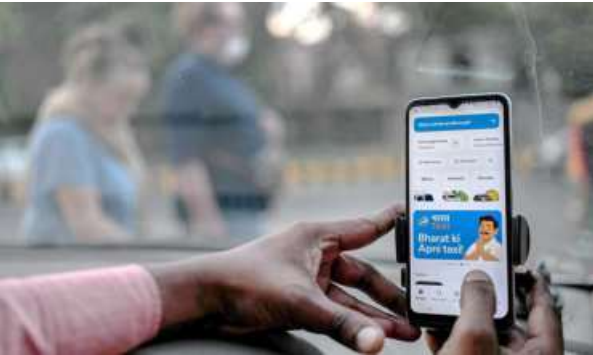
As smartphone prices increase due to a spike in demand for memory chips by AI companies and data centres, phone retailers have seen customer base dry up in a significant way.

“This is the first time I’m seeing phone prices increase, and continue increasing relentlessly, in the last 20 years,” said Vivek Singh, 42, a phone retailer in south Delhi, who has been in the business for decades. “I have 10 or 15 people coming into the shop each day, and only one or two buy a phone,” he said. Since February, phone makers have been sending retailers price hike notifications that have been progressively growing.

The Hindu obtained such notifications from Vivo, Samsung, Realme, Oppo, Nothing, Poco, and Xiaomi from the All India Mobile Retailers Association (AIMRA).

Price hikes have ranged from ₹1,000 to ₹5,000, but that is only the latest tranche. “People ask me for ₹10,000 phones, but there is no such thing any more,” Mr. Singh rued, noting that some budget handsets’ prices have more than doubled.

The results of these



Pocket unfriendly: Price hikes have ranged from ₹1,000 to ₹5,000, but that is only the latest tranche. AFP

hikes have not been completely doom and gloom just yet, at least not yet.

Kailash Lakhyani, AIMRA's founder chairman, told *The Hindu* that retailers were beginning to see better prices for pre-owned phones they got during trade-in purchases, and that retailers who had already purchased stock at an old dealer price were benefiting from a higher margin at newer prices.

A review of price hike notifications showed that some retailers saw their margins jump from 3.85% to over 14% for some Samsung phones. “60% of phones are being purchased overall,” Mr. Lakhyani claimed. “20% of customers are settling for less powerful phones, or buying second hand, and the 20% of customers below that are waiting for the festival season hoping for

discounts,” he added. “There’s also a rumour of a GST cut for smartphones, so some customers are waiting for that,” he said. The GST for smartphones stands at 18%. But this situation may worsen. “We have been in touch with phone companies, and they say this situation may go on till 2028 or even 2030,” Mr. Lakhyani said. “Next year also there will be hikes, but it may be more like a plane rather than a rocket [like this year was],” he added.

The phenomenon is global, as the memory chip crunch created by AI demand has hit electronics supply chains across the board. “Global sub-\$200 smartphone shipments are forecast to fall -40% between 2025 and 2030,” Counterpoint Research, a smartphone sales analyst firm, said on Thursday.

Economy resilient with downside risks from West Asia conflict: RBI bulletin

Ashokamithran T.
MUMBAI

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI), in its monthly bulletin released late on Friday, stated that the Indian economy had stayed resilient despite global uncertainties rising from the West Asia crisis.

“The escalation of conflict in West Asia in September has led to a sharp increase in crude oil prices, reigniting concerns of a further disruption in global supply chains and build-up of inflationary pressures,” the RBI stated.

Pressure on finances

“Alongside, the rise in sovereign yields in some of the major advanced economies has put pressure on government finances. Despite such a challenging global environment, the Indian economy recorded a strong GDP growth in Q1:2026-27,” it said.

“High-frequency indicators through August reflected sustained demand with segments of industry and services sectors displaying resilience,” the RBI added in the bulletin.

The central bank further flagged inflationary tendencies in the economy transmitting as crude prices have begun increasing again. “Headline CPI inflation picked up in August 2026. Core inflation excluding precious metals has also increased from ultra-low levels of recent



The central bank flagged inflationary tendencies in the Indian economy.

months,” the RBI said.

Commenting on the foreign exchange reserves, the regulator said that the special deposit scheme for non-resident Indians (NRIs) led to a record high reserve position of \$766 billion as of September 18, 2026.

“The reserves provided cover for 11.2 months of goods imports [as on September 18] and more than 100% of the external debt outstanding as at end March 2026,” the RBI stated in the bulletin.

FCNR B flows also led to an increase in system liquidity, which has resulted in quickening deposit growth potentially supporting the ongoing credit growth cycle. On the external front, the RBI said that India's financial and external sectors drew strength from the real economy, despite geopolitical tensions and weather-related uncertainties are acting as key downside risks.

Power plants may blend imported coal with domestic supplies

Reuters
NEW DELHI

India is considering telling power plants to blend imported coal with domestic supplies for the first time since 2024, three government sources said, to ease a supply crunch that has pushed monthly spot power prices to their highest since 2022.

Higher global coal demand and rising freight costs are set to make imports costlier, as Indonesian prices are up about a fifth since May while Russian prices are 14% higher and South African rates are up 19%, traders say.

5% blending

Under the plan being discussed by the officials of the power ministry, thermal power plants would have to blend up to 5% imported coal with domestic coal, said the sources, who are directly aware of the matter.

The plan represents a sharp reversal in New Delhi's drive to boost domestic coal production and curb imports, which helped prune overseas supplies over the past two years.

Most of India's coal-fired power plants rely primarily on domestic coal, but can blend up to 15% imported coal.

Indian coal imports are already at a 15-month high.

The government's previous coal-blending directives ran from December 2021 to March 2024.

Tea production slips, shipments decline in January-July 2026

M. Soundariya Preetha
COIMBATORE

India's tea production declined 1.7% year-on-year (YoY) to 658.3 million kg during January-July this year, according to data shared by the United Planters' Association of Southern India (UPASI).

While the country's tea output in 2025 had grown 7.1% YoY, production during the first seven months of this year saw pressure across major tea-growing regions. Output in South India declined 4.4% and production in North India fell 0.9% largely due to climatic conditions linked to changing weather patterns. India's tea exports shrank 16.1% YoY to 128.56 million kg between January and July this year.

Meanwhile, the Tea Board of India's newly launched Tea Mark certification programme has gained initial traction, with 25 producers and mini factories receiving certification so far. The initiative, introduced in July, aims to promote speciality teas produced by small tea growers and bought-leaf factories by enhancing quality standards, branding and market access.

Tesla drives growth with sixth India Experience Centre in Tamil Nadu

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tesla India on Friday opened its sixth Experience Centre in the country here, expanding retail and after-sales presence in Tamil Nadu.

The firm also started service and body-shop operations here taking the network in India to eight locations.

“We already have experience centers in Mumbai, Gurugram, Delhi, Hyderabad, Bangalore and now, we are in Chennai,” said Sharad Agarwal, Tesla India's head.

Tesla said the Chennai Experience Centre would provide local consultation, test drives and vehicle delivery support.

The company has also



Going global: The experience centre would offer local consultation, test drives and vehicle delivery support. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

made available Tesla-approved collision centre and service capabilities at Poonamallee, providing access to genuine Tesla parts, trained technicians, software-aware diagnostics and collision repair.

“We have built the capability to establish a home charging network anywhere in this country -- in any city or state. And we are already delivering across the country. We have delivered Tesla in more than 21 States,” he said.

Tesla now has five Supercharging stations in India and is also expanding destination charging and home charging infrastructure.

ture, Mr. Agarwal said. The firm follows a direct-to-consumer model, allowing customers to order vehicles without visiting an Experience Centre. Tesla offers Model Y Premium Rear-Wheel Drive at ₹50.89 lakh with a ‘range of up to 500 km.’

The three-row, six-seat Model YL starts at ₹61.99 lakh with a ‘range of up to 681 km.’

Tesla vehicles have no prescribed maintenance schedule, he claimed. Over 70% problems can be resolved remotely.

Tesla also introduced Grok AI in its cars.

“With Grok AI, you can control a lot of features inside the car. You no longer have to touch and find the features. You sit and give the command,” he said.

GREATER VISAKHAPATNAM MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
e Procurement Tender Notice No.: 38/2026-27(SE/WS&S-M)/EE/1(WS&S-M)/DB/DT: 24-09-2026

1. No. of Works	: 1 No
2. Value of Works	: Rs.164.61 Lakhs
3. Downloading Starting Date	: 25-09-2026
4. Downloading ending date	: 28-09-2026 @ 4.00 PM
5. Last date of bid submission	: 28-09-2026 @ 4.30 PM
6. Date of PQ Opening	: 28-09-2026 @ 5.00 PM
7. Date of Commercial Opening	: 29-09-2026 @ 5.00 PM

Note: For any other details required in respect of above tender notice, please contact EE-(WS) before applying for tender schedules and visit website @ www.aeprocurement.gov.in.

For Commissioner

PUNJAB STATE WAREHOUSING CORPORATION
SCO 74-75, Bank Square, Sector-17B Chandigarh
PBX: 0172-5197847, 5197846

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

PSWC invites online tenders through GeM Portal for creation of 0.70 LMT godown capacity at 01 location in the State of Punjab for guaranteed lease of 10 years on Build, Own and Operate / Lease basis for storage requirements of FCI under two bid system 'Technical Bid' and 'Financial Bid'.

NIT (alongwith GeM Bid IDs) is available on Department's website i.e. <https://pswc.in>

PSWC reserves the right to scrap the tender at any stage without assigning any reason and PSWC will not be held liable for any costs and consequences incurred by the intending bidders.

Note: Any corrigendum(s) / Notification (s) to this Notice Inviting E-Tender shall be published Department's website & GeM Portal.

1004/12/2026-27/15586**Managing Director, PSWC**

AP POWER GENERATION CORPORATION Ltd., VS, VIJAYAWADA-520004
(A Govt. of A.P Undertaking)

TENDER ID: 993206

APGENCO invites Competitive Bids (in Two Parts) on AP e-Procurement platform from eligible bidders for "Lifting of 1.0 MMT of raw coal from M/s SCCL Naini Coal Mine and transportation of raw coal from SCCL Naini pithead to any of the nearest railway siding by Road mode, stacking and loading of raw coal into railway wagons from siding and delivery to Dr.NITTPS".

Schedule available Date & Time : **24.09.2026** - 20.00 Hrs onwards

Bid submission Closing Date & Time : **15.10.2026** - 15.00 Hrs

For other details visit the website: <https://tender.aeprocurement.gov.in>

DIPR 5459PP/CL, Dt: 25/09/2026

OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER, PHED, REGION AJMER
PHONE NO. 0145-2624748 Email-aceregionajmer@gmail.com
No. F.(J)/Ar.MP/2026-2027/ 10353-10402 Dated :23.09.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDERS FOR WORKS

Bids for the Work of Augmentation and Rehabilitation of UWSS Ajmer, District Ajmer including 5 years of O&M after 01 year Defect Liability period Under AMRUT 2.0 (NIT No. **06/2026-27**; Estimated Cost Rs.13107.47 Lacs) are invited from interested bidders up to 28.10.2026 Other particulars of the Bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.raj.nic.in>) of the state.

UBN No. PHE2627WLOB05681
NIB No. PHE2627A2709

(Jagdish Prasad Sharma)
Additional Chief Engineer
PHED, Region, Ajmer

DIPR/C/16460/2025-26

Government of India, Department of Space
Indian Space Research Organisation
LIQUID PROPULSION SYSTEMS CENTRE
Valiamala.P.O., Thiruvananthapuram-695 547

Advertisement No. LPSC/03/2026 dated 26/09/2026

Applications are invited for the following posts for LPSC Valiamala near Thiruvananthapuram.

Post No.	Discipline	No. of vacancies	Essential requirements
Scientist / Engineer-'SC' [Level 10 (Pay Matrix : ₹56,100/- – ₹1,77,500/-)]			
820	Welding	01	1. B.E./B Tech in any of the following: Mechanical / Production / Metallurgy / Manufacturing / Material Science AND 2. M.E./M Tech in any of the following: Welding Technology / Mechanical Welding and Sheet Metal Engg. / Manufacturing (with welding as one of the subjects) / Metallurgy (with welding as one of the subjects) / Production (with welding as one of the subjects)
821	Turbo Machinery	01	1. B.E./B Tech in any of the following: Mechanical / Aerospace AND 2. M.E./M Tech in any of the following: Turbo Machinery / Thermal & Fluids Engg. (with Turbo Machinery as one of the subjects) / Aerospace Propulsion (with Turbo Machinery as one of the subjects)
822	Power Electronics	01	1. B.E./B Tech in any of the following: Electronics & Communication / Electronics & Instrumentation / Applied Electronics / Electrical & Electronics / Electrical / Avionics / Power Engg. AND 2. M.E./M Tech in any of the following: Power Electronics / Power Electronics and Control / Power Control and Drives / Advanced Electrical Power System / Electrical and Electronics (Power Systems) / High Voltage and Power Systems Engg. / Industrial Power Control and drives

Note: The educational qualification (B.E./B.Tech/M.E./M.Tech) should have been completed within the stipulated duration of the course as prescribed by the University.

Age limit as on 13.10.2026 is 30 years for all posts. Ex-Servicemen, Departmental candidates and Persons With Benchmark Disabilities (PWBD) are eligible for upper age relaxation as per Govt. of India orders. Applications will be received **only through on-line**. Interested candidates may visit the website www.lpsc.gov.in for detailed information and filling-up on-line application form. For this purpose, the on-line recruitment portal will be available **from 1400 hrs on 29.09.2026 to 1400 hrs on 13.10.2026**.

Weekend Sport

Operating in a silo or fitting into the whole – what’s in a Sprint?

Introduced in 2021 as a way to jazz up the days leading up to a Formula One Grand Prix, the Sprint race has had a chequered history. Yet, for the 2027 season, the big bosses of F1 have increased its number from six to 10. What’s behind the move and how to enhance the product’s value?

S. Dipak Ragav

On September 16, F1 unveiled its 2027 calendar with 24 races scheduled across five continents. Headlines from the announcement included confirmation of a return to venues like Portimao in Portugal and Istanbul in Turkey.

While the number of races has hovered around 22 to 24 in recent years, the highlight for 2027 is the increase in Sprint races from six to 10. Sprints are shortened dashes of 100 kilometres, held on Saturdays ahead of the main Grand Prix on the Sunday. Ever since the *Drive to Survive* series first aired on Netflix in 2019, F1’s popularity has skyrocketed, making its races some of the best-attended sporting events in the world.

To cash in on the surge, and help race promoters get more bang for the buck, Sprints were introduced in 2021 to ensure that all three days of the weekend had context-heavy sessions that could affect the outcome of the Championship.

In the pre-Sprint era, the F1 race schedule had largely followed a similar format for decades – a few practice sessions on Friday, followed by another one on Saturday ahead of qualifying, and the all-important battle on Sunday.

It meant that most of the Friday running was for teams and drivers to fine-tune their cars and arrive at the ideal set-up. Often, teams didn’t even run in the first half hour of Friday’s first practice because the track was ‘dirty’.

The transformation

Sprints, by also offering Championship points, changed the equation. In the first two years of their existence, there was a seamless transition from one session to the next. A single

Now that F1 has decided to double down on the Sprint, the sport needs to figure out how to make it distinct and exciting rather than a mini-Grand Prix

free practice on Friday was followed by a Sprint pole shootout (in the standard qualifying format) to set the grid for Saturday’s Sprint Qualifying (the 100km race). Saturday’s outcome set the grid for Sunday’s marquee contest, with the winner earning pole position.

However, it came with its own issues. Drivers were overly cautious in the Sprints to avoid damage that could hurt them in the main race. It also messed up some historical records, including what counted as a pole position.

In 2021, the winner of the Sprint Qualifying was given the pole stat. But with many, including the likes of Lewis Hamilton and Sebastian Vettel, believing that pole position should reflect single-lap prowess and not that of a mini-race, it was changed in 2022 to reward the fastest man in Friday’s shootout. But that led to another paradox – the quickest on Friday would get the pole stat and the right to go first in the Sprint, but the top starter in Sunday’s main menu would still be the Sprint winner and not the pole-position holder.

Decoupling

To clear this confusion, world governing body FIA and F1, in 2023, decided to run Sprint as a standalone event on Saturdays, with its own qualifying called Sprint Shootout. Qualification for Sunday’s main race was held Friday evening.

In 2024, this stop-start, incoherent order was rectified by conducting the qualification for the Sprint on Friday, and the Sprint race first up on Saturday. Qualifying for Sunday’s blue-ribbon competition would follow.

F1’s rationale for adding programmes is positive fan feedback. “Since the Sprint was

introduced in 2021, data shows that total viewership of Sprint weekends is 12% higher than non-Sprint weekends,” the head honchos stated recently. “Sprint Qualifying is up to three times more popular with fans than Free Practice; 82% of attendees at Sprint weekends say it adds value to their ticket; 75% of F1 fans believe Sprint events add greater value to a season’s calendar.”

Now that we are six years into the Sprint, it is a good time to explore what it has achieved.

Every day of a Sprint weekend now has more purpose, and any competitive action is better than watching cars run by themselves.

But have these special occasions delivered anything memorable? Not much. In 2023, Max Verstappen clinched his third title at the Qatar GP Sprint, but that, for a purist, was a pedestrian way of crowning a World champion.

These contests haven’t been exciting because the format doesn’t differ much from a normal race day. Yes, there are no pit stops, which should enable drivers to race the wheels off to gain position. However, that seldom happens, as the men behind the steering wheel are often risk-averse, especially if they are outside the points-scoring placings.

The racing maxim is that if faster cars start from behind, they will eventually move up, thereby building excitement. The 2005 Japanese GP, widely considered as one of the best races ever, is a good example.

Iconic drivers such as Michael Schumacher, Fernando Alonso and Kimi Raikkonen started 14th, 16th and 17th respectively, after a rain-affected qualifying session. Raikkonen and Alonso charged up to the front, with the former clinching victory through a sensational pass on the final lap while the latter came home third.

In the junior formulas below F1,

the Sprint is often a reverse-grid competition where the fastest among the top-eight drivers starts eighth. It is designed that way to help developing drivers learn to pass cars and build wheel-to-wheel racing skills.

In F1, however, the overriding focus is fairness, for the stakes are much higher. This has led to the organisers being less bold. Once the cars clear the first-lap jeopardy, Sprints often settle into a predictable rhythm, without even the strategic differences found in the main race. While only a handful of drivers have won both the Sprint and the Grand Prix in the same weekend, there have not been many outlier winners or podium-finishers to build excitement in Sprints either.

Ways to improve

Now that F1 has decided to double down on Sprints, the sport needs to figure out how to make it a distinct and exciting product rather than a mini-Grand Prix.

Reverse grids are an option, but they could be problematic in places where overtaking is difficult, like Monaco, which incidentally is one of 10 Sprint events next season. Drivers do not seem enamoured by the idea, as they feel it could have a significant impact on the Championship table.

One way to jumble up the grids is to go back to one-shot qualifying, like in the early 2000s. In that format, drivers would go on to the track in a pre-determined order – Championship standings or results from the previous race – and get only one attempt to set their fastest lap. Even a small mistake could prove costly, or sudden rain during the session could trip them up.

F1 could also play around with tyre compounds. A bespoke, Sprint-specific compound that isn’t durable for the entire race can bring to the fore drivers’ tyre-management skills and spice up the racing, provided these events are run on tracks where overtaking is easier.

A 12% increase in viewership because of Sprints is indeed good, and the onus is now on F1 to do more to improve a product designed for spectacle than sporting purity. It is better to take a risk and fail than not try at all.

GETTY IMAGES



STACKING UP

ATP Men's Top 15				
#	Player	Age	Points	Events
1	Jannik Sinner	25	11,500	17
2	Alexander Zverev	29	9,690	20
3	Carlos Alcaraz	23	5,560	17
4	Ben Shelton	23	4,680	22
5	Félix Auger-Aliassime	26	3,890	22
6	Daniil Medvedev	30	3,770	23
7	Flavio Cobolli	24	3,720	26
8	Frances Tiafoe	28	3,380	22
9	Alex de Minaur	27	3,300	24
10	Taylor Fritz	28	3,175	22
11	Arthur Fils	22	3,150	18
12	Novak Djokovic	39	2,980	16
13	Learner Tien	20	2,715	21
14	Rafael Nadal	20	2,659	21
15	Jakub Menšik	21	2,495	21



Top Indians ▶


Sumit Nagal
Rank 248 ▼ 1 spot


Dhakhshinewar Suresh
Rank 359 ▲ 8 spots

WTA Women's Top 15				
#	Player	Age	Points	Events
1	Elena Rybakina	27	9,901	21
2	Aryna Sabalenka	28	7,875	19
3	Jessica Pegula	32	7,265	19
4	Coco Gauff	22	7,244	18
5	Mirra Andreeva	19	5,743	20
6	Linda Nosková	21	5,328	20
7	Elina Svitolina	32	4,809	17
8	Karolína Muchová	30	4,683	20
9	Iga Świątek	25	4,119	18
10	Marta Kostyuk	24	4,040	17
11	Amanda Anisimova	25	3,363	15
12	Belinda Bencic	29	2,935	18
13	Iva Jovic	18	2,841	23
14	Diana Shnaider	22	2,588	23
15	Victoria Mboko	20	2,521	19

Top Indians ▶


Sahaja Yamalapalli
Rank 349 ▲ No change


Valshnavi Adkar
Rank 361 ▲ 2 spots

F1 Drivers' standings				
#	Driver	Team	Points	Wins
1	A.K. Antonelli	Mercedes	292	8
2	G. Russell	Mercedes	211	2
3	L. Hamilton	Ferrari	191	1
4	L. Norris	McLaren	186	2
5	C. Leclerc	Ferrari	167	1
6	M. Verstappen	Red Bull	145	0
7	O. Piastri	McLaren	120	0
8	I. Hadjar	Red Bull	71	0
9	L. Lawson	RB	59	0
10	P. Gasly	Alpine	41	0
11	A. Lindblad	RB	31	0
12	F. Colapinto	Alpine	27	0
13	O. Bearman	Haas	18	0
14	G. Bortoleto	Audi	10	0
15	N. Hulkenberg	Audi	7	0
16	C. Sainz Jr.	Williams	6	0
17	A. Albon	Williams	5	0
18	E. Ocon	Haas	3	0
19	F. Alonso	Aston Martin	3	0
20	Y. Tsunoda	RB	1	0
21	L. Stroll	Aston Martin	0	0
22	V. Bottas	Cadillac	0	0
23	S. Perez	Cadillac	0	0


A.K. Antonelli


L. Hamilton

F1 Constructors' standings			
Pos	Team	Points	Wins
1	Mercedes	503	10
2	Ferrari	358	2
3	McLaren	306	2
4	Red Bull	230	0
5	RB	77	0
6	Alpine	68	0
7	Haas	21	0
8	Audi	17	0
9	Williams	11	0
10	Aston Martin	3	0
11	Cadillac	0	0



Badminton Men's ranking			
#	Player	Points	Events
1	Jonatan Christie	87,631	17
2	Kunlavut Vitidsarn	86,915	16
3	Christo Popov	86,632	19
4	Anders Antonsen	85,405	17
5	Chou Tien Chen	85,200	26
6	Shi Yu Qi	84,075	13
7	Kodai Naraoka	77,540	19
8	Alex Lanier	76,985	15
9	Victor Lai	76,465	17
10	Alwi Farhan	71,619	17
11	Lin Chun-Yi	64,924	18
12	Li Shi Feng	64,533	15
13	Loh Kean Yew	63,860	19
14	Lakshya Sen	62,813	20
15	Toma Junior Popov	62,697	19

Top Indians ▶


Lakshya Sen
Rank 14


Ayush Shetty
Rank 20

Badminton Women's ranking			
#	Player	Points	Events
1	An Se Young	121,287	15
2	Wang Zhi Yi	103,989	15
3	Akane Yamaguchi	102,576	18
4	Chen Yu Fei	86,651	14
5	Ratchanok Intanon	74,606	19
6	Putri Kusuma Wardani	72,023	17
7	Tomoka Miyazaki	71,456	21
8	Pornpawee Chochuwong	69,027	15
9	Han Yue	69,008	12
10	Nozomi Okuhara	64,160	18
11	P.V. Sindhu	64,151	12
12	Kim Ga Eun	59,281	16
13	Line Christophersen	57,940	21
14	Michelle Li	55,327	20
15	Mia Blichfeldt	54,483	11

Top Indians ▶


P.V. Sindhu
Rank 11


Unnati Hooda
Rank 24



Test Batting			
#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Harry Brook	861	898
2	Steve Smith	840	947
3	Joe Root	816	932
4	Travis Head	811	884
5	Temba Bavuma	775	806
6	Rachin Ravindra	740	740
7	Rishabh Pant	713	801
8	Daryl Mitchell	710	804
9	Shubman Gill	709	807
10	Kamindu Mendis	706	784

ODI Batting			
#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Shubman Gill	801	841
2	Daryl Mitchell	794	840
3	Virat Kohli	767	908
4	Rohit Sharma	758	879
5	Ibrahim Zadran	719	756
6	Babar Azam	689	894
7	Joe Root	675	810
8	Shai Hope	673	782
9	Harry Tector	653	730
10	Kusal Mendis	648	654

T20I Batting			
#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Ishan Kishan	904	916
2	Abhishek Sharma	893	931
3	Sahibzada Farhan	848	848
4	Harry Brook	793	793
5	Jos Buttler	789	794
5	Dewald Brevis	789	806
7	Phil Salt	775	881
8	Pathum Nissanka	757	796
9	Tilak Varma	726	845
10	Mitchell Marsh	706	706

Test Bowling			
#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Mitchell Starc	872	872
2	Matt Henry	861	870
3	Ollie Robinson	856	856
4	Jasprit Bumrah	853	908
5	Pat Cummins	841	914
6	Marco Jansen	825	825
7	Kagiso Rabada	807	902
8	Scott Boland	804	820
9	Josh Hazlewood	783	864
10	Noman Ali	777	853

ODI Bowling			
#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Rashid Khan	714	775
2	Abrah Ahmed	675	675
3	Mitchell Santner	644	650
4	Maheesh Theekshana	635	680
5	Jofra Archer	633	682
6	Keshav Maharaj	626	737
7	Shaheen Afridi	604	691
8	Mehidy Hasan Miraz	602	722
9	Kuldeep Yadav	596	757
9	Gudakesh Motie	596	638

T20I Bowling			
#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Abrah Ahmed	736	757
2	Rashid Khan	735	828
3	Adam Zampa	700	746
4	Adil Rashid	695	747
5	Nathan Ellis	675	678
6	Jamie Overton	674	674
7	Varun Chakravarthy	671	818
8	Mohammad Nawaz	658	672
9	Wanindu Hasaranga	656	809
10	Jasprit Bumrah	651	783

BLAZING TO GLORY

Puripol smashes own Games record to win the 100m gold



REUTERS

Thailand's Puripol Boonson broke his own Asian Games record to win men's 100m in 9.90s. Puripol's semifinal run of 9.91s had eclipsed the 9.92s set by China's Su Bingtian in 2018. The Thai shaved another 100th off that in the final to finish well clear of the Omani pair of Ali Al-Balushi (10.04s) and Malham Al-Balushi (10.11s).

AMAZING RUN

China's Chen bests Singapore's Shanti for women's 100m title



AFF

China's Chen Yujie won the women's 100m in an Asian Games record (11.06s) to push Hangzhou gold medallist, Singapore's Shanti Pereira (11.21s), to silver. Bahrain's Edidiong Odiong took bronze in 11.33s. Chen's exploits were watched by a sparse crowd, with the Mizuho Park Stadium only about a quarter full.

NO STOPPING HIM

China's Zhang wins record seventh Asiad swimming gold medal



REUTERS

Chinese teenager Zhang Zhanshuo won a record seventh swimming gold at the Asian Games on Friday and said that it was the "perfect conclusion" to his week in Tokyo. The 19-year-old wrapped up a scintillating campaign with victory in 400m freestyle in a Games record time of three minutes, 41.28 seconds.

JOY AND DESPAIR

Sachin reaches quarterfinals, Preeti knocked out in last-16



FILE PHOTO

India's Sachin Siwach advanced to the men's 60kg quarterfinals with a 4-1 win over Jordan's Mohammad Adnan Abu Jajeh at the Asian Games in Nishio on Friday. Preeti Pawar, who had received a first-round bye, went down 0-5 in an unanimous verdict to North Korea's Pang Chol in a women's 54kg round-of-16 contest.

Suruchi and Kamaljeet end wait for shooting gold

The Indian pair produces a new Asian and Games record in the 10m air pistol mixed team event; the men's 50m rifle 3P team of Tomar, Niraj and Rudrankksh bags silver behind China



Double delight: Suruchi and Kamaljeet won the gold with a record-breaking effort while Rudrankksh, Tomar and Niraj did enough to land a silver. R.V. MOORTHY

ASIAN GAMES

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

India's wait for a shooting gold from the Aichi General Shooting Range finally ended on the sixth day of the competition. Suruchi Phogat and Kamaljeet combined to not only win the 10m air pistol mixed team event but also set a new Asian and Games record in the process. Suruchi and Kamaljeet, having both shot ordinary scores in their respective individual events, made up for the disappointment as a team, totalling 484.6 points in the final. Suruchi, in particular, was in fine form and was largely responsible for keeping India ahead right from the start, first in the qualifying round and then in the final. Suruchi shot a series of 99, 97 and a perfect 100 in the qualifying to total 296, the highest by any shooter, while Kamaljeet tried to keep pace with a 291. In the final round, Suruchi again kept getting as close to the middle as possible, consistently scoring in high 10s for 245.7 points.

Kamaljeet could only manage 238.9 but together it was enough for gold and a new record. Desperate to win Suruchi and Kamaljeet, both making their maiden continental appearance, propped up each other to break the shooting gold drought. They revealed that the individual disappointments had made them desperate. "I was really upset and sad after the individual event. I had never expected to score so less – it was almost 20 below my average, it was unacceptable, especially in qualification. "I realised something was wrong. Samresh (Jung) sir said it wasn't in our control and that there was another chance in the mixed team. He keeps telling us that you are a true athlete only when you manage to go back up after being down." Kamaljeet, who failed to make it to the final by a single point a day before, was more candid. "I thought I had another chance to go back with a medal. It is not difficult to be mentally ready," he declared. India has already lost three of the seven golds it won in shooting last time

around, although Friday's win made up for it a little. However, the 22-medal haul from Hangzhou now looks a far shot. One of those golds that India failed to defend was in the men's 50m rifle 3-positions team event, where it finished with a silver. Aishwary Pratap Singh Tomar, the joint owner of the qualifying Games record of 591, could only manage a 589. Niraj Kumar and Rudrankksh Patil shot 588 and 585, respectively, as the Indian trio managed a combined score of 1762, four behind China. Tomar, also the Asian record holder and Niraj, however, disappointed in the individual event, finishing fifth and eighth respectively. Far from convincing Tomar, silver medallist in the previous edition, was far from convincing, struggling to find his rhythm and the target in all three positions. With several of his shots scoring only nines, the 25-year-old had 102.9 in kneeling and 102.4 in prone for the first two rounds to trail top-placed and eventual champion Liu Yukun of China by 3.2 points.

THE INDIA SHOW

A look at some Indian performances on Friday:

Athletics: Women's shot put final: Manpreet (bronze), Krishna (fifth); Women's pole vault final: Baranica (bronze); Women's 400m: Kiran (second in heat 2) and Prachi (third in heat 3), both qualified for the final; Women's heptathlon: Pooja (sixth), Anamika (eighth). Men's 10,000m final: Gulveer (silver); Men's 400m: Vishal (first in heat 2), qualified for the final; Men's 100m semifinals: Gurindervir (11th overall) and Animesh (18th overall), both DNQ for final; Men's hammer throw final: Damneet (ninth), Praveen (11th). **Badminton:** First round: Women: Unnati bt Yu (PRK) 2-0; Doubles: Gayatri & Treesa bt Tsang and Lui (Hkg) 2-1; Kavipriya & Simran lost to Kusuma & Puspitasari (Ina) 0-2. Men: Doubles: Satwiksairaj & Chirag lost to Pakkapon & Peeratchai (Tha) 1-2; Hariharan & Arjun lost to Fajar & Shohibul (Ina) 0-2. Mixed doubles: Dhruv & Tanisha bt Aminath & Nibal (Mdv) 2-0. **Boxing:** Round-of-16: Men's 60kg: Sachin bt Jajeh (Jor). Women's 54kg: Preeti lost to Mi (PRK). **Equestrian:** Dressage team final: Fourth (Shruti, Hriday, Gaurav, Jai). **Fencing:** Table-of-16: Men's foil team: lost to Hong Kong 27-45; Women's epee team: lost to

Uzbekistan 29-45. **Hockey:** Women (Pool B): bt Japan 3-1. **Kabaddi:** Semifinals: Women: bt Nepal 48-24; Men: bt Thailand 66-28. **Shooting:** 10m air pistol mixed team final: Suruchi & Kamaljeet (gold); 50m rifle 3P men individual final: Aishwary Pratap (fifth), Niraj (eighth); Team final: Silver (Aishwary Pratap, Niraj, Rudrankksh). **Squash:** Quarterfinals: Men: Abhay bt Tsukue (Jpn) 3-0; Veer lost to Irfan (Pak) 1-3. Women: Anahat bt Tanvi 3-0; Mixed doubles: Velavan & Joshna bt Pelino & Aribado (Phi) 2-0. **Swimming:** Men: 200m backstroke final: Rishabh (sixth), Utkarsh (seventh); 200m butterfly final: Sajjan (seventh); 50m breaststroke: Danush (21st overall), DNQ for final; 400m freestyle: Aneesh (17th overall) and Dhakshan (18th overall), both DNQ for final. **Table tennis:** Mixed doubles: Semifinals: Manush & Diya lost to Wang & Sun (Chn) 0-4, bagged bronze. Quarterfinals: Harmeet & Yashaswini lost to Lin & Kuai (Chn) 0-3. Men: Round 2: Manush bt Faraji (Iri) 4-0; Manav lost to Ryong (PRK) 2-4. Women: Round 2: Yashaswini bt Zaza (Syr) 4-1; Sreeja lost to Gyong (PRK) 1-4. **Weightlifting:** Women's 61kg final: Nirupama (seventh).

SNAPSHOTS

Manush-Diya duo wins mixed doubles bronze India's Manush Shah and Diya Chitale finished with a bronze in the table tennis mixed doubles event after losing to China's Wang Chuqin and Sun Yingsha 8-11, 5-11, 8-11, 2-11 in the semifinals on Friday. In the quarters, Manush and Diya had stunned the World No. 4 duo of Doo Hoi Kem and Wong Chun Ting of Hong Kong 11-6, 13-15, 11-9, 11-5.

Kabaddi teams on the cusp of glory The Indian men's and women's kabaddi teams stayed on course for a successful defence of their gold medals as they posted facile wins to enter the finals. The women marched into the summit clash with a 48-24 win over Nepal before the men joined them with a 66-28 victory against Thailand. The two teams will be up against

Iran, which beat Chinese Taipei in both the semifinal clashes. **Three medals assured in squash** Indian squash players assured themselves of three medals as Joshna Chinappa and Velavan Senthilkumar entered the mixed doubles semifinals while Anahat Singh and Abhay Singh advanced to the last four in singles. **Satwik-Chirag pair suffers shock defeat** Defending men's doubles champions Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty suffered a shock opening-round exit while the mixed combination of Tanisha Crasto and Dhruv Kapila progressed to the quarterfinals with back-to-back wins. The Thailand duo of Pakkapon Teeraratsakul and Peeratchai Sukphun defeated Satwiksairaj and Chirag 12-21, 21-19, 21-14.



Fine show: Manush and Diya secured India's first TT medal at the ongoing Games. FILE PHOTO: R. RAVINDRAN

Gulveer secures a silver; Baranica makes history in pole vault; bronze for Manpreet



Stealing the show: Gulveer bettered his bronze from Hangzhou in 10,000m while Baranica became the first Indian pole vaulter to win an Asiad medal. Shot putter Manpreet came up with a 17.17m throw to earn a spot on the podium. R.V. MOORTHY

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

It needs a touch of magic to share the spotlight with Gulveer Singh's incredible consistency. On Friday, Baranica Elangovan managed to do so, soaring high and leaping into history as the first ever Indian to win an Asian Games medal in pole vault. The 29-year-old cleared a height of 4.15m to take joint bronze with Polina Ivanova of Kazakhstan at

the Paloma Mizuho athletics stadium here. It was nowhere close to her best, but it was enough to add India's third medal from track and field on day two of the competition after Manpreet Kaur captured bronze in shot put and Gulveer bettered his own performance with a silver in the 10,000m. Birhanu Balew of Bahrain won the gold (28:27.51s). The other two are events that India has done reasonably well in the past.

Pole vault, meanwhile, is an outlier in Indian athletics; women's vaulting even more. Sindhushree, however, had a disappointing outing, ending with no mark against her name. Gulveer, on the other hand, has redefined consistency. As much as Nee-raj Chopra has been the poster boy of athletics, Gulveer comes close, in terms of performances if not necessarily in medals. On Friday, the 28-year-

old added yet another achievement to his kitty, winning silver in 28:29.38, improving on his bronze from three years ago. The timing was far from his personal or even season's best but it hardly mattered. He could be in action three more times through the next few days, starting with the 1500m heats on Saturday followed by the final and the 5000m. Manpreet managed a best throw of 17.17m in her

fourth attempt to end up on the podium behind the Chinese pair of Song Jiayuan (19.40) and Zhang Linru (18.14). Krishna Jayasankar came fifth with a best of 16.57m. Damneet Singh was ninth in hammer throw with 67.56 while Praveen Kumar threw 65.24 to finish 11th. Kiran Pahal (53.44s) and Prachi (53.46) advanced to the final of the 400m, as did Vishal T.K. (45.27) among the men.

INDIANS IN ACTION

A look at some Indian players/teams who will compete on Saturday (all times IST):

Athletics: Men's marathon final (Sawan, Kartik), 4 a.m.; Men's decathlon, 5.30 a.m. onwards; Men's 200m heats (Animesh), 8 a.m.; semifinals, 4.50 p.m.; Women's long jump qualification (Shaili, Ancy), 8.10 a.m.; Women's 100m hurdles heats (Jyothi, Nandhini), 4 p.m.; Women's 200m heats (Unnathi, Harita), 4.25 p.m.; Men's shot put final (Tajinderpal, Karanveer), 4.30 p.m.; Men's triple jump final (Praveen, Karthik), 5 p.m.; Men's 1500m heats (Gulveer, Yoonus), 5.20 p.m.; Women's 400m final (Kiran, Prachi), 6.15 p.m.; Men's 400m final (Vishal), 6.30 p.m.; Women's 1500m final (Parul, Pooja), 6.45 p.m. **Badminton:** 2nd round: Men: Lakshya vs. Yew (Sgp), 6 a.m.; Women (not before 11.30 a.m.): Unnati vs. Ching (Mas); Doubles (not before 2.30 p.m.): Treesa & Gayatri vs. Mayu & Yuki (Jpn). **Boxing:** Last-16: Men's 55kg: Jadumani vs. Paalam (Phi), 10.15 a.m.; Men's 90kg: Kapil vs. Estaki (Iri), 2.15 p.m.; Women's 60kg: Priya vs. Yeonji (Kor), 5.45 p.m. **Hockey:** Men (Pool A): vs. Japan, 1.30 p.m. **Kabaddi:** Finals: Women: vs. Iran, 9.30 a.m.; Men: vs. Iran, 2.30 p.m. **Shooting:** 50m rifle 3P women individual qualification and team final (Tilottama, Ashi, Vidarsa), 6.15 a.m.; individual final, 9.30 a.m. **Squash:** Semifinals: Mixed doubles: Velavan & Joshna vs. Yi & Hong (Hkg), 8.30 a.m.; Women: Anahat vs. Watanabe (Jpn), 10.30 a.m.; vs. Abhay vs. Irfan (Pak), 11.15 a.m. **Table tennis:** Women (round 3): Yashaswini vs. Harimoto (Jpn), 6.30 a.m.

INBRIEF



Mercedes’ Russell takes pole for Azerbaijan GP

Mercedes’ George Russell produced a superb performance in qualifying on Friday to take pole position for this weekend’s Azerbaijan Grand Prix but his teammate and World championship leader Kimi Antonelli, crashed and will start 16th. McLaren’s Oscar Piastri and Red Bull’s Isack Hadjar fill the second row of the grid ahead Lando Norris, fifth in the second McLaren and Ferrari’s Lewis Hamilton in sixth. Pierre Gasly (Alpine), four-time champoion Max Verstappen (Red Bull), Carlos Sainz (Williams) and Franco Colapinto (Alpine) rounded out the top 10.

Kusal Mendis and Wellalage the stars in Lanka’s victory

Kusal Mendis struck a century while left-arm spinner Dunith Wellalage bagged three top-order wickets as Sri Lanka defeated England by 16 runs in the second ODI in Leeds to finally earn a win on its white-ball tour.

The scores: Sri Lanka 321/6 in 50 overs (Kamindu Mendis 54, Kusal Mendis 121, Rathnayake 48) bt England 305/9 in 50 overs (Banton 73, Duckett 67, Buttler 69, Jacks 52). **Toss:** Sri Lanka; **PoM:** Kusal Mendis.

Report says City found guilty of 114 Premier League charges

Manchester City has been found guilty of all but one of 115 Premier League charges it faces for breaching financial regulations, the *Athletic* reported on Friday. The report added that no sanction had yet been decided and that City is set to appeal. The outcome of an independent hearing that began more than two years ago could send shock waves through English football. The legacy of City’s trophy-laden era is on the line over accusations it had been built on financial impropriety. City was charged by the Premier League in 2023 following investigation into alleged breaches between 2009 and 2018.

LIVE TELECAST

- Cricknet:** Asian Games (Men), Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 10.30 a.m.
- Formula One:** Azerbaijan GP, F1 TV, F1 TV Pro App & Fan-Code, 6.30 p.m.
- Football:** Nations League, Sony Sports Ten 1, 2, 5 & LIV, 9.30 p.m. & 12.15 a.m. (Sunday)
- Asian Games:** Sony Sports Ten 5 & LIV, 5.30 a.m. (Sunday)

Former players back Turkey, call for reform

Vivek Krishnan
NEW DELHI

Amid the escalating rifts within Hockey India (HI), a group of former players has thrown its weight behind HI president Dilip Tirkey and called for urgent reform in the running of the federation.

Some members of the group, of which illustrious names like Zafar Iqbal, V. Baskaran and Ashok Kumar are a part, gathered for a protest at the Major Dhyan Chand National Stadium here on Friday.

While the aforementioned trio couldn’t be in attendance, Olympians Vineet Kumar and Romeo James, who were part of the Indian team at the 1984 Los Angeles Olympics, were among those who made their voices heard.

Having been denied permission by the authorities to express dissent inside the venue, the former players held placards outside Gate No. 7.

The tussles in the governing body came into prominence on September 12 when Director General Cdr. R.K. Srivastava was stripped of all his powers and asked to explain repeated instances of non-compliance with Tirkey’s directives. Srivastava had travelled to the recent World Cup in the Netherlands and Belgium despite



In a tussle: Dilip Tirkey, Hockey India president. FILE PHOTO: R. RAGU

Tirkey directing him not to do so.

The factional discord was exacerbated a couple of days later when Srivastava accompanied secretary general Bhola Nath Singh to Chandigarh for the formal announcement of the men’s Asian Champions Trophy even as Tirkey was meeting Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya in New Delhi. An emergent Executive Board meeting on September 18 was then called by Bhola Nath without Tirkey’s sanction.

Former India women’s team captain Asunta Lakra, who had accused Bhola Nath of intimidating her with consequences after she raised objections to the alleged harassment of

India lets Panama off the hook in draw

Williams hands the home team the lead before a thunderous left-footed strike from Valencia restores parity for the visitor in the second half

FOOTBALL

Ashwin Achal
BENGALURU

The Indian football team was on the brink of pulling off a mighty upset. That was until a thunderous strike brought the home side back to earth.

Taking on significantly higher-ranked Panama at the Sree Kanteerava Stadium in an international friendly here on Friday, India looked on course for a memorable victory after Ryan Williams gave it a 1-0 lead in the 41st minute.

There was a sense of disbelief, mixed with elation, as India continued to dominate. Panama, boasting World Cup pedigree, looked completely out of

sorts. It was left to Panama substitute Omar Valencia to pull the visitor out of the hole. Against the run of play, Valencia unleashed fierce a left-footed strike from well outside the box, leaving custodian Gurpreet Singh Sandhu stranded.

The 68th-minute goal saved Panama, ranked 44th in the world, from an embarrassing defeat. India, ranked 138th, continued to attack without fear, but could not find a second goal.

Admittedly, this was not Panama’s strongest team, with only two players in the starting XI – Cesar Blackman and Tomas Rodriguez – having featured at the World Cup earlier this year.

It was, nevertheless, a spirited performance from the Indians, who consis-

tently created the better chances. The deadlock was broken when a defensive lapse allowed Williams to run through with only the goalkeeper to beat. A cool finish from the forward sent the loud crowd into a frenzy.

Ecstasy turned to silence later when Valencia produced his stunner, but the home faithful remained engaged thanks to the relentlessly aggressive Indians.

Edmund Lalrindika came closest to securing a match-winner, but missed from close range in the dying minutes.

Manvir Singh fluffed a backheel, allowing Panama to escape with pride intact.

The result: India 1 (Williams 41) drew with Panama 1 (Valencia 68).



The poacher: Williams showcased his goal-scoring ability yet again. K. MURALI KUMAR

Gukesh’s brilliance helps India pip Germany; women crush Uzbekistan

CHESS OLYMPIAD

Sports Bureau

After a while, India had a well-nigh perfect day at the Chess Olympiad. Both the men’s and women’s teams won their matches in the ninth round at Samarkand on Friday.

After conceding draws in the previous round, both teams had to win their matches. The men encountered a strong challenge from the giant-killer Germany before winning 2.5-1.5, while the women crushed host Uzbekistan 3-1.

The Indian men owe their win to World champion D. Gukesh, who showed resilience and brilliance to defeat Alexander Donchenko on the fourth board. He came back from an inferior position and found a superb knight manoeuvre on his way to a 54-



Contrasting day: Gukesh posted a crucial win for India while his World championship challenger Sindarov faced defeat. FIDE

move victory with black pieces.

The other games, featuring R. Praggnanandhaa, Arjun Erigaisi and Nihal Sarin were all drawn. India has 15 points and is in joint second position in the open section, along with Uzbekistan (2) and Armenia.

With 16 points, Uzbekistan is in the sole lead. Just two rounds remain.

In the women’s event too, India is placed second

with 15 points, alongside Kazakhstan and Mongolia. Former champion China is the sole leader with 17 points.

The Indian women were too good for Uzbekistan, though B. Savitha Shri, for the first time in the tournament, failed to win. After winning all her seven games, she was forced to split the point, with Guldona Karimova, but Divya Deshmukh and Vantika Agrawal won their games.

Important results (ninth round): Open: India bt Germany 2.5-1.5 (R. Praggnanandhaa drew with Vincent Keymer; Arjun Erigaisi drew with Matthias Bluebaum; Nihal Sarin drew with Frederik Svane; D. Gukesh bt Alexander Donchenko)

Uzbekistan bt USA 2.5-1.5; China drew with France 2-2; Uzbekistan (2) bt Netherlands 3.5-0.5; Armenia bt Azerbaijan 2.5-1.5; Hungary bt Austria 3-1; Ukraine bt Georgia 2.5-1.5; Spain bt Czech Republic 3-1; Bulgaria drew with Turkiye 2-2; Brazil drew with Greece 2-2.

Women: India bt Uzbekistan 3-1 (Koneru Humpy drew with Afruza Khamdamova; Divya Deshmukh bt Gulrukhbegim Tokhirjonova; Vantika Agrawal bt Nilufarkhon Imomkuzieva; B. Savitha Shri drew with Guldona Karimova).

China bt Armenia 3-1; Kazakhstan drew with Mongolia; Georgia drew with Greece; France bt Serbia 2.5-1.5; Poland bt Cuba 2.5-1.5; Indonesia bt Germany 2.5-1.5; Vietnam bt Bulgaria 3.5-0.5; USA bt Canada 3-1; Azerbaijan bt Czech Republic 4-0; Netherlands bt Argentina 2.5-1.5.

Tirkey lodges police complaint against HI officials and staff

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

The absolute dominance by Indian teams on the field at the Asian Games here has been marred by the off-field ugliness in the sport’s administration back home.

The latest low point in the power struggle within the different factions of Hockey India (HI) is an official police complaint filed by president Dilip Tirkey against HI officials and staff

alleging harassment, intimidation and fraud.

The complaint, dated September 24 and submitted to the DCP, South Delhi office, seeks filing of a formal FIR against HI Director B.N. Bhushan, suspended Director General Cdr. R.K. Srivastava and a couple of others.

“... under relevant provisions for criminal breach of trust, theft, criminal conspiracy, endangerment of life, and wrongful abandonment and request for

immediate recovery of stolen assets and documents,” the complaint states.

Sources said Tirkey, currently on a visit to the national capital, had travelled using a vehicle arranged by HI. The vehicle had allegedly been recalled by HI without any intimation to Tirkey, with all his personal belongings and documents in it, and then gone incommunicado. Both Srivastava and Bhushan did not respond to queries on the complaint.

Klopp denied on his Germany debut

NATIONS LEAGUE

Agence France-Presse
PARIS

Jürgen Klopp was denied a winning start to his reign as Germany coach when Cody Gakpo scored a late equaliser to earn the Netherlands a 1-1 draw in their UEFA Nations League clash on Thursday.

In another game, reigning champion Portugal saw off Wales.

Erling Haaland picked up where he left off for Norway with two more goals for his country in a

thrilling 3-2 victory over Denmark.

The results:

League A: Group 2: Netherlands 1 (Gakpo 90+2) drew with Germany 1 (Nmecha 32); Serbia 1 (Zivkovic 4) lost to Greece 2 (Tzolis 74, Douvikas 90+5).

Group 4: Portugal 1 (Felix 22) bt Wales 0; Norway 3 (Bobb 14, Haaland 18, 74) bt Denmark 2 (Damsgaard 25, Hojlund 60).

League B: Group 3: Austria 3 (Schmid 43-pen, Mwene 90, Kalajdzic 90+3) bt Israel 1 (Abu Frachi 55); Kosovo 1 (Muriqi 83) bt Republic of Ireland 0.

League D: Group 1: Andorra 1 (Lopez 17) lost to Malta 2 (Cardona 36, Teuma 81).

Dahiya replaces Sarandeep as coach of Delhi cricket team

Vivek Krishnan
NEW DELHI

Former wicketkeeper-batter Vijay Dahiya was, on Friday, appointed as head coach of the Delhi men’s senior team for the 2026-27 domestic season. The 53-year-old, who featured in two Tests and 19 ODIs for India, replaces Sarandeep Singh in the role.

After his retirement in 2006, Dahiya has had multiple stints as Delhi’s coach. Most notably, it was in his first tenure that Delhi last won the Ranji Trophy in the 2007-08 season. Since then, Delhi’s best perfor-



Vijay Dahiya. FILE PHOTO

mance has been a runner-up finish in the 2017-18 campaign. While the northern outfit has seven Ranji titles to its name, it hasn’t lived up to its illustrious history in recent years.

Dahiya will hope to put his experience to good use and resurrect Delhi’s standing. His support staff will include former pacers

Lakshya came to Uttarakhand when he was 10 and went through the under-16 and under-19 levels before playing Ranji Trophy cricket. He continues to practise there.

“My family has never stopped me from doing anything. They have supported me a lot,” he added.

Perhaps that is why his parents and elder brother travelled with him to Sri Lanka earlier this year and were in Rajkot.

He is shy, more comfortable letting his cricket do the talking.

He has played First Class cricket for Uttarakhand, scoring 223 runs in four outings, including three half-centuries.

New role

And on Sunday, when the multi-day series begins, he will be vice-captain, with Yashbardhan Singh Chauhan taking over as captain.

A fan of Virat Kohli and Joe Root, Lakshya is not looking too far ahead.

The cameras still make him uncomfortable. But his aim is to wear the national colours at the highest level.

Parvinder Awana and Sanjeev Sharma as bowling coaches. Kshitiz Sharma and Kuldeep Rawat have been named assistant coaches.

Rajkumar Sharma, who is renowned as Virat Kohli’s childhood coach, has been given the role of mentor for the season.

The selection committee will be headed by K.P. Bhaskar. The three-member panel also comprises Manu Nayar and Praveen Gupta.

Delhi will begin its Ranji season with a Group C duel against Bengal from October 11.